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ANNEX

ANNEX

to the

COMMISSION IMPLEMENTING DECISION

approving the third release of funds to the Republic of Moldova under the Reform and Growth Facility for the Republic of Moldova

Annex to the Commission Implementing Decision approving the third release of funds to the Republic of Moldova under the Reform and Growth Facility for the Republic of Moldova

Assessment of the Conditions for Payments - Republic of Moldova

Commission's assessment of the preconditions for Union support

Effective democratic and rule of law mechanisms

Moldova continues to implement justice sector reforms, in particular through the vetting process, strengthening the integrity and independence of the judiciary. The fight against corruption has also advanced, with a clarification of the roles and cooperation between relevant institutions and stronger anticorruption mainstreaming.

The functioning of democratic institutions is satisfactory. Moldova shows a continued commitment to implementing reforms, despite hybrid attacks from Russia and its proxies on democratic institutions, that aim to undermine social cohesion in the country. The capacity of public institutions, including of the Bureau of European Integration, continued to strengthen to help deliver the work of the government on the EU integration.

Following the resignation of Prime Minister Munteanu, **the change of government was swift and orderly, in full respect of constitutional procedures.** On 21 July 2026, the Parliament approved the new government led by Prime Minister Tofan. The new government's programme continues to prioritise Moldova's EU accession, reforms, strengthening of democratic institutions, and economic growth.

The Parliament has an oversight role over the executive. Accountability lines between the Parliament and other relevant institutions are established, with the Parliament appointing state officials at the head of central administrative institutions and independent institutions. Further efforts are needed to increase the Parliament's transparency, accountability, integrity, and overall effectiveness. This includes enhancing the track record of parliamentary oversight of independent institutions and ensuring a timely and comprehensive publication of parliamentary activities and decisions**.** While Moldova's legal framework requires at least 10 working days' notice, this requirement is not always complied with, and more timely publication of public consultations and parliamentary documents is needed to enable meaningful stakeholder participation and strengthen the inclusiveness and transparency of the legislative process.

The legal electoral framework provides a sound basis for conducting democratic elections. During the last elections, the national authorities worked actively and in a coordinated manner to prevent, detect and counter foreign interference attempts, including illicit financing and vote-buying schemes, with the aim of safeguarding electoral integrity and democratic process. Nonetheless, some OSCE/ODIHR and Venice Commission

recommendations remain unaddressed. Moldova should ensure its legislative framework pertaining to elections, including the Law on combating electoral corruption, is brought fully in line with European standards. The upcoming regional elections in Gagauzia should be organised in line with EU and international standards, including the Venice Commission's recommendations.

Freedom of expression is generally guaranteed in Moldova, and significant progress has been made in aligning the country's legislative framework with the EU acquis. Moldova adopted a Law on the Media, which extended ownership transparency requirements to print and online media and further harmonised the legal framework with the European Media Freedom Act. Amendments to the Audiovisual Media Services Code were also adopted to bring the legislation fully into line with European standards. Moldova should now ensure the effective implementation of these laws by all relevant parties. Through the Media Subsidy Fund, 22 new media projects were supported in 2026, helping to bolster a sector that continues to face structural economic difficulties. Progress was made in reinforcing the protection of journalists against intimidation, notably through the development of an Action Plan on journalists' safety and amendments to the Criminal Code which enabled the prosecution of cases of cyberviolence against media workers. Systematic law enforcement investigations and consistent judicial follow-up of cases of threats against journalists need to be ensured.

Respect for all human rights obligations

The legislative and institutional framework on fundamental rights is largely in place, and Moldova continues to meet its international obligations on human rights. Implementation of the national human rights action programme is ongoing. Institutional capacity and implementation efforts need to be strengthened to guarantee the full enjoyment of human rights. Mechanisms for preventing and countering gender-based violence are in place. Detention conditions, progress on deinstitutionalisation and access to specialised support services for victims of gender-based violence, including shelters and psychological support, should be improved. The legislative framework safeguards the rights of persons belonging to minorities. Moldova should continue to support intercultural dialogue and efforts to include ethnic minorities in public administration.

Based on the above assessment, Moldova continues to fulfil the preconditions for Union support under Article 10 of Regulation (EU) 2025/535.

General conditions

Macroeconomic and financial stability

Following a stagnation in 2024, **real GDP reached 2.4% in 2025 and became increasingly broad-based towards the end of the year.** While in the first quarters of 2025 growth was mainly driven by a recovery of agricultural output following the 2024 drought and construction, the last quarter outturn was marked by a strong pick up of the IT and manufacturing

sectors. Real GDP slowed to 0.4% in the first quarter of 2026, as slowing consumption and a contraction in investment outweighed robust export growth. On the supply side, gains in manufacturing and retail trade were offset by sharp contractions in real estate, IT, and construction. Preliminary data from the second quarter of 2026 suggest that the real GDP increased by 0.9%.

The external sector continues having persistent structural challenges. In 2025, the current account deficit increased to 19.7% of GDP, up from 16.6% in 2024. This reflects a strong deterioration in the trade balance, mainly on account of a surge in imports due to robust demand, as well as a sharp increase in electricity imports after Russian gas to the Transnistrian region was cut off. During the first quarter of 2026, the current account deficit narrowed by 17% year-on-year but remained elevated at 20.9% of GDP, reflecting a lower trade deficit supported by higher exports and lower imports. Foreign currency reserves increased during the first quarter by 3.2% to EUR 5.3 billion, equivalent to almost six months of import coverage.

Monetary and Fiscal Policies

Inflation has picked up again in 2026. It briefly returned to the Central Bank's target range in January 2026 before re-accelerating on the back of a sharp increase in global energy prices following the conflict in Iran and the wider Middle East, peaking at 6.8% in April 2026 before stabilising at 6.3% in July. Renewed inflationary pressure prompted a policy rate increase to 6.5% in May and further to 7% and 7.5% in June and August respectively.

The predominantly foreign-owned banking sector demonstrated continued stability with strong capital adequacy, liquidity, and profitability. Non-performing loans edged up again during the first months of 2026 but remain relatively low at 5.3%. The impact of a proposed temporary increased income tax on banks remains to be assessed.

The 2025 fiscal deficit reached 4% of GDP, lower than the 5% of GDP target and broadly unchanged from previous year's outturn of 3.9% of GDP reflecting capital expenditure under-execution and slightly higher than expected revenues. The 2026 deficit is projected at 5.7% of GDP driven by a shift towards investment-led spending. However, mid-year data suggests an under-execution of investment expenditure.

In 2025, the public debt-to-GDP ratio increased by 1 percentage point, reaching 39.2% by the end of the year, primarily driven by the high fiscal deficit, partly offset by favourable stock flow adjustments due to exchange rate developments. The IMF's latest public debt sustainability analysis confirmed a low risk of external debt distress and moderate risk of overall public debt distress. Most external state debt is owed to multilateral lenders, with the EU's (including EIB) share accounting for 29% of the total in mid-2026. Sovereign credit ratings from Fitch (B+), S&P Global (BB-), and Moody's (B2) all carry stable outlooks.

Vulnerability to External Shocks and Resilience Efforts

Moldova faces substantial external vulnerabilities. These include structural current account imbalances**,** mainly due to heavy reliance on volatile agricultural exports, and energy import

dependency, and low levels of preparedness against extreme weather events and climate change. At the same time, Moldova remains dependent on concessional external financing, while FDI levels remain low at 1.8% of GDP in 2025.

Existing resilience-building efforts by the government include maintaining foreign reserves above five months of import coverage, implementing targeted energy support programs, and support measures for broadening the export base. Services export expansion provides some diversification, while stable remittance flows continue supporting the economy. The banking sector's strong fundamentals provide financial stability.

The international support framework remains robust. Following Moldova's request in January 2026 for a new IMF programme, a staff-level agreement for a three-year non-disbursing IMF Policy Coordination Instrument (PCI) was reached with the previous government on 20 May. Negotiations for the programme continue bilaterally with the new government. Moldova participated in the economic and financial dialogue with the EU in May 2026, following the submission of its third economic reform programme. Implementation of the 2025 policy guidance was partial.

Policy Mix Assessment and Medium-term Stability

Moldova remains committed to macroeconomic stability and economic reforms despite a difficult external environment. The macroeconomic policy mix has contributed to sustaining macroeconomic stability amidst the several recent crises, including the latest energy price increase, but public investment remains very low, and the country is vulnerable to external shocks. The May 2026 Economic Policy Dialogue joint conclusions provided concrete recommendations for macroeconomic and financial stability, fiscal sustainability, and sound monetary policies.

Moldova's SOE sector remains economically significant, while the implementation of the triage results has been slow. There are around 900 SOEs registered at central and local level, with roughly one third under central government. In 2025, around 220 SOEs were reported active at the central level. In 2024, the authorities completed a triage of 238 enterprises: 66 were deemed unsuitable for privatisation, 55 proposed for conversion into another legal form, 20 for privatisation and 97 for liquidation. However, the implementation has been slow, with privatisation process launched for only five SOEs; another 10 SOEs should be liquidated and 15 reorganised by end 2026. Financial performance and fiscal risks are concentrated in a small number of large enterprises, notably in energy, transport, communications and public services of which some record significant losses. Although the legal framework for corporate governance has improved, ownership responsibilities remain fragmented, the separation between ownership and policymaking is weak.

The fiscal policy contribution to medium-term stability presents mixed signals. With structural fiscal deficits expected to remain elevated over the medium term, the public debt-to-GDP ratio is projected to be on a rising trajectory, albeit still relatively low. This is subject to several risks, including foreign exchange developments, contingent liabilities stemming from

government guarantees and potential reclassification of several indebted state-owned enterprises into the general government sector. In addition, the persistent under-execution of capital expenditure suggests implementation challenges.

Monetary policy has generally supported stability despite external shocks. Inflation rose above the National Bank of Moldova's target range during the first half of 2026, driven mainly by energy price shocks, before returning within the target range in July. Nonetheless, inflationary risks remain elevated, driven by the conflict in the Middle East, uncertainties related to the agricultural recovery and the fiscal stimulus provided by the Growth Plan. Banking sector stability persists with strong fundamentals. The increase of the NPL ratio warrants monitoring but remains manageable.

The policy mix appears broadly coordinated and generally conducive to stability. Engagement with the IMF and EU provides external discipline and support, reinforcing domestic policy efforts and sending positive signals to the market. The key challenge is balancing growth support with deficit reduction while addressing structural vulnerabilities, particularly the large current account deficit.

The policy mix is generally conducive to stability, but its effectiveness will ultimately depend on consistent and high-quality implementation of structural reforms, diversification of the economic base, and strengthening institutional capacity, particularly in managing state-owned enterprises and improving public expenditure efficiency and increasing public investment implementation.

Based on the above assessment, Moldova continues to fulfil the general conditions related to macro-financial stability.

Public financial management (PFM)

Moldova is implementing a comprehensive PFM Reform Strategy 2023-2030, developed based on lessons learned from the previous strategy covering 2013-2022 and findings from the 2022 PEFA assessment. The strategy addresses identified weaknesses in budgetary discipline, public investment management, capacity constraints, and external audit independence. SIGMA's mid-term review of the strategy was finalised in June 2026 at the request of the Ministry of Finance. The review noted a high rate of implementation of reform actions but recommended updating the strategic framework to include a robust monitoring framework with measurable indicators and to strengthen its linkage with the EU *acquis*. The new government remains committed to PFM reforms and implementation of the Public Administration Reform roadmap. However, sustained implementation requires strengthened capacity.

Credibility and Relevance of PFM Reforms

The reform strategy demonstrates strong credibility and relevance through its evidence-based approach, drawing from multiple diagnostic assessments. The reforms appropriately target the identified weaknesses. Legislative proposals have been introduced to institutionalise

spending reviews into the budget process, alongside a methodology, enhancing systematic evaluation of public expenditure. In November 2025, a comprehensive legislative package was introduced to amend the Law on Public Finance and Fiscal Responsibility, establishing mandatory budget reporting for extra-budgetary entities from 2027 onwards. This change will enhance budget transparency by incorporating additional units partially funded by the budget but not currently included in national public budget reporting.

Main Achievements Since Previous Assessment

Moldova has demonstrated tangible progress through several key achievements. The Single Project pipeline approach to capital investments was consistently implemented in the first half of 2026. The new methodology on spending reviews, approved in June 2026, sets the framework for conducting these reviews, including the responsibilities of the institutions involved. Budgetary transparency improved through legal amendments that reclassify public institutions under self-management, establishing a more rigorous accounting and reporting requirements. The qualifications of public procurement specialists improved significantly with the introduction of a certification requirement, and trainings began in March 2026 under the new scheme. The establishment of public investment management focal points and subdivisions in line ministries strengthened public investment management implementation, ensuring proper review and approval mechanisms for new public capital investment projects. All new projects included in the 2026 State Budget were appraised on the new IT platform.

The Court of Accounts reformed its internal governance. To address overlapping responsibilities, the Court of Accounts clarified the roles of its President, Members, and Head of Office. Each member was assigned responsibility for one element of the Quality Management System, ensuring quality management became a collective leadership responsibility, rather than a separate technical function. In addition, the Court of Accounts financial autonomy was significantly enhanced in June 2026 with legal amendments, strengthening the role of the legislative branch and substantially limiting the role of the executive branch in approving the budget of Court of Accounts.

Progress with budgetary reforms has been mixed. The 2026 Budget Law improved budget transparency by reducing the General Actions section of the state budget to below 30%, primarily by reassigning transfers to the Mandatory Medical Insurance Funds and State Social Insurance Budget to their respective ministries. Even so, this share remains high. Progress in other areas has been more limited. The medium-term budgetary framework 2026 -2028 was prepared and submitted for approval at the ministerial level but has not been adopted. Likewise, spending reviews for health and social sectors have not been endorsed by the government, despite efforts to improve spending efficiency in both sectors. By end July 2026, the 2026-2028 medium-term budgetary framework has not been adopted, held up by pending tax and salary reforms and a change of government. Managerial accountability requires continued strengthening, and the authorities are taking concrete steps to address this. Government Decision No. 284/2025 established a clear delimitation of responsibilities between ministries and subordinated authorities and the Ministry of Finance is developing a Guide on the

delegation of responsibilities within a delegated management system, with a pilot exercise planned by the end of 2026.

Anti-Fraud Measures and Response to Corruption Cases

Moldova has established a robust anti-fraud system. The anti-fraud unit (State Inspectorate of Financial Control) signed fourteen cooperation agreements with network members, establishing clear regulatory frameworks and functional institutional mechanisms. These agreements ensure clear allocation of responsibilities, standardisation of reporting and intervention processes, and coherent information flow among relevant authorities. The network brings together the State Chancellery, the Ministry of Finance, the Court of Accounts, the National Anti-Corruption Centre, the central bank, prosecution authorities, and other key institutions. Moldova has submitted the draft anti-fraud programme to OLAF for review.

Capacity to Manage and Monitor Reforms

The institutional capacity to manage and monitor reforms presents mixed results. While the key institutions remain committed to reform implementation, significant capacity constraints persist. The shortage of qualified staff in internal audit units represents a critical weakness affecting reform sustainability. The loss of human resources poses challenges to maintaining the pace and quality of reforms, requiring urgent attention to recruitment and retention strategies. Moreover, the mid-term review of the PFM reform strategy 2023-2030 noted that its action plan lacks a result monitoring framework**.** However, the authorities are addressing capacity constraints in internal audit through targeted recruitment, restructuring and professional development measures. The restructuring of ministry units increased auditor positions by 73% (from 33 to 57), with 37 recruitment competitions held between January 2025 and April 2026, alongside strengthened certification and training.

Transparency and oversight of the budget

Between 2023 and 2025 the Government continued making publicly available the budgetary documents. The latest Open Budget Survey (OBS) for 2023, published in 2024, scored Moldova Budget Transparency 81/100, in ranking significantly better than its peers and improving the 2019 score. The budget related documents are accessible online with all relevant laws and regulations. The Ministry of Finance has prepared and published annual Citizens' Budgets based on the enacted budgets since 2015. The Medium-Term Budget Framework for 2025-2027, the 2026 State Budget Law, timely approved in December 2025, as well as the budgets of the State Social Insurance Budget and the Mandatory Health Insurance Fund are made publicly available in full, and easily accessible.

Budget oversight continued to improve. In October 2025, the Court of Accounts (CoA), Moldova's Supreme Audit Institution, extended its Development Strategy by two years, until 2027. Additionally, a 2025-2027 Audit Strategy was approved in December 2024 with the involvement of the EU and SIGMA. The first international peer review was successfully organised in 2022, and a follow up performance report was published in December 2025 to assess progress. The report notes that the CoA operates under well-developed legal and

institutional arrangements. The CoA's Functional independence has improved, notably with regards to self-organisation without undue influence and with increased freedom over organisation structure. Furthermore, amendments to strengthen CoA's constitutional and financial independence have been adopted in June 2026.The lack of capacity hinders the work of the institution. However, the Court of Accounts filled 13 positions in 2025, including 7 audit positions, and strengthened professional development, with 119 employees participating in 45 training activities between May and August 2026. The dedicated Public Financial Control Committee in the parliament is functioning properly; however, it could benefit from further support and empowerment. Ethical and integrity safeguards were reinforced through adoption of the Code of Ethics and establishment of an Ethics Committee, aligning with ISSAI 130 and INTOSAI-P 20. Furthermore, Moldova established a standardised mechanism for following up on the Court of Accounts' recommendations, with 31 central authorities addressing outstanding recommendations, 23 adopting action plans and 8 reporting no delays in implementation. The Court of Accounts has also strengthened public communication and transparency through live-streamed meetings, information campaigns and cooperation with media platforms, resulting in more than 500 media materials and journalistic investigations based on its work.

Based on the above assessment, Moldova continues to fulfil the macro-financial stability, PFM, and budget transparency criteria.

PEFA assessment

PEFA Assessment (2011 framework)	**2015 PEFA**	**2022 PEFA**	**Progress**
PI-6: Comprehensiveness of information included in budget documentation	A	A	No change
PI-7: Extent of unreported government operations	A	B+	Deterioration
PI-10: Public access to key fiscal information	B	A	Improvement
PI-24: Quality and timeliness of in-year budget reports	C+	B+	Improvement
PI-25: Quality and timeliness of annual financial statements	C+	D+	Deterioration
PI-26: Scope, nature and follow-up of external audit recommendations	B+	A	Improvement
PI-27: Legislative scrutiny of the annual budget law	B+	B+	No change
Open Budget Index	**OBI 2017**	**OBI 2019**	**OBI 2021**
	57	65	81

Key Budget Document	**Produced (Yes/No)**	**Published (website) (Yes/No)**	**Timeline**	**Comprehensiveness and quality**	**Evolution since last disbursement**
MTBF 2025-2027 (*proxy pre-budget statement)*	Yes	Yes	The medium-term budgetary framework 2025-2027, approved by Government Decision No. 561/2024 on 7 August 2024. (the deadline in the LPFFR 181 is 1 June)	Completely revised and improved framework and content since 2018-2020 MTBF. Need to consider revising the calendar to make it more realistic.	Ensure consistent political engagement in the MTBF process. Adhere to the Budget Calendar.
2026 State Budget	Yes	Yes	2026 budget approved by the Government and adopted by the Parliament on 29 December 2025 *(the deadline in the LPFFR 181 is 15 October)*	Information is complete and comprehensive as far as the basic elements are concerned. Fiscal Risk Statement has been added since the 2018 State Budget Law.	Address classification and disclosure issues.
Enacted 2026 Budget	Yes	Yes	Enacted on 29 December 2025. *(the deadline in the LPFFR 181 is 1 December*)	*As above*	*As above*
In-year (monthly) 2026 Budget Execution reports	Yes	Yes	Yes, monthly reports	Information is complete and comprehensive.	Inclusion of budget comparator would be beneficial. The reports

Key Budget Document	Produced (Yes/No)	Published (website) (Yes/No)	Timeline	Comprehensiveness and quality	Evolution since last disbursement
					make helpful year on year comparisons, however.
Mid-year 2025 Budget Execution report	Yes	Yes	The mid-year budget report for 2025 was published on 1 October 2025. *(The deadline in the LPFFR 181 is 15 September*)	Complete and comprehensive but lacking consistency in quality in the explanatory narrative.	The analysis and presentation of the review could be enhanced. Prepare and publish consistently and with improved quality.
Year-end 2025 Budget Execution report	Yes	Yes	*The year-end budget execution report for 2025 was submitted to the Court of Accounts on 26 May 2025.* *The report was published on the MoF website on 27 May 2026.* *The deadline in LPFFR is 15 April.*	Information is complete and comprehensive, but not compliant with IPSAS / NPSAS. The structure, content of information, and accompanying explanatory narrative could be improved.	IPSAS requires comparison of budget and actual where the budget is publicly available.
SAI Audit Report of 2025 Budget Execution	Yes	Yes	*The Audit Report was published on 26 May 2026.*	Information is complete and comprehensive. The reports are compliance focussed and change little from year to	Improve quality in line with INTOSAI standards

Key Budget Document	Produced (Yes/No)	Published (website) (Yes/No)	Timeline	Comprehensiveness and quality	Evolution since last disbursement
			(the deadline in the LPFFR 181 and Law on CoA is 1 June)	year. Would benefit from greater emphasis on performance and systemic internal control issues.	
Citizen's Budget 2026	Yes	Yes	Yes	Good quality to-date in preparation and timely publication. Information is complete and comprehensive.	No immediate issues.

Commission's assessment of the satisfactory fulfilment of the steps included in the third instalment of the Reform Agenda

The Commission has reviewed the information provided by the beneficiary and has no indication that the implementation of the steps contravenes the general principles outlined in Article 4 and 9(4) of Regulation (EU) 2025/535 and Article 3 of the Facility Agreement, or the 'Do No Significant Harm' principle (DNSH).

Pillar 1 – Private sector development
Reform: Enhanced export competitiveness of Moldova trade in goods

The step under review	Reform Agenda step No. 19: Full-fledged implementation of the Customs Decision system (CDS) with 17 out of 17 applications/authorisations operational.
Description	Pursuant to the full implementation of the Customs Decision System, customs will be able to provide access to all customs simplifications, such as authorised consignor/consignee, special seals, entry in declarant's record, centralised clearance, comprehensive guarantee, simplified declaration.
Baseline	In December 2024, the Customs Decisions System is partly operational with 4 out of 17 types of applications/authorisations in place. Low numbers of economic operators are using simplifications.
Deadline of the step	June 2026
Commission assessment of results	Through Government Decision No. 222/2026 adopted on 1 May 2026, Moldova established the legal framework for the Customs Decisions System (CDS) and enabled the digital processing of customs decisions. Two relevant Customs Service orders (No. 259-O/2026 and No. 272-O/2026) were adopted in June 2026, setting out the data requirements, formats and codes for customs decisions processed through the CDS, and regulating the system's use. Previously, in December 2025, the Customs Service approved the *Guide on Customs Decisions* as a self-learning tool for the use of the CDS IT system. By January 2026, Moldova implemented 8 out 17 modules of Customs Decisions System and by June, the CDS was fully operational, enabling the electronic submission, processing and management of all 17 types of customs applications and authorisations as listed below: 1. Authorisation for the status of authorised consignor for transit (ACR): 5 applications received, 5 authorisations granted.

	2. Authorisation for the status of authorised consignee for transit (ACE): 21 applications, all granted. 3. Authorisation for the status of authorised consignee for International Road Transport (TIR) operations (ACT): 1 application, granted. 4. Authorisation for the use of seals of a special type (SSE): 4 applications, all granted. 5. Authorisation for the use of the temporary admission procedure (TEA): 1 128 applications, 1 045 granted. 6. Authorisation for the provision of a comprehensive guarantee, including possible reduction or waiver (CGU): 37 applications, 19 granted. 7. Authorisation for the use of a transit declaration with a reduced data set (TRD): 0 applications. 8. Authorisation for the use of an electronic transport document as a customs declaration (ETD): 0 applications. 9. Authorisation for the simplification of the determination of amounts being part of the customs value of goods (CVA): 0 applications. 10. Authorisation for deferment of payment (DPO): 0 applications 11. Authorisation for the operation of temporary storage facilities (TST): 0 applications. 12. Authorisation to use a simplified declaration (SDE): 0 applications. 13. Authorisation for making a customs declaration through an entry of data in the declarant's records (EIR): 0 applications. 14. Authorisation for the use of the inward processing procedure (PA): 0 applications. 15. Authorisation for the use of the outward processing procedure (PP): 0 applications. 16. Authorisation for the use of the end-use procedure (EUS): 0 applications. 17. Authorisation for the operation of storage facilities for customs warehousing of goods in a private customs warehouse (CWP): 0 applications. While Government Decision No. 222/2026 establishes Moldova's national CDS as the future national component of the EU CDS and covers several authorisations that support centralised clearance, the Centralised Clearance Authorisation itself will be managed through the common EU component of the system.

Conclusion of the review of the step by the beneficiary	The beneficiary considers the step to be satisfactory fulfilled.
Checks performed and evidence used in the verification of the step and related findings	1. Government Decision No. 222/2026 on the Information System "Customs Decisions", published on 1 May 2026 in the Official Gazette No. 190–193, Article 225: 2. Customs Service Order No. 259-O/2026 approving the data requirements, formats and codes for customs applications and decisions processed through the Information System "Customs Decisions", published on 23 June 2026 in the Official Gazette No. 269–272, Article 473a: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3289/part/3#page=1 3. Customs Service Order No. 272-O/2026 approving the Regulation on the use of the Information System "Customs Decisions", published on 25 June 2026 in the Official Gazette No. 277–279, Article 488a: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3291/part/3#page=29 4. General Guide on Customs Decisions, approved by Customs Service Order No. 566-O of 26 December 2025: https://trade.gov.md/api/media/05/01/2026/Anexa_nr._1_Ghidul_general_privind_Deciziile_vamale_S7MsR4E.pdf 5. Handover and Acceptance Confirmation Act for the Project: Strengthening the Operational Capacity of the Customs Service of the Republic of Moldova (CSRM) PHASE 1, of 30 June 2026. 6. Hyperlink to Moldova Trade Information Portal: https://trade.gov.md/ro/articles/ncts 7. Hyperlink to the Customs Decision System (CDS): https://api.customs.gov.md/#/home 8. Activity report of the Customs Service for the second quarter of 2026: https://customs.gov.md/api/media/29/06/2026/Raport_PASV_proiect_2026_trim_II_1.pdf
Double funding	Contributions from third parties in support of the fulfilment of this step were reported, but the results were delivered by the Moldovan government.
Clear conclusion on the achievement of the step	**Satisfactorily fulfilled**

Pillar 1 – Private sector development
Reform: Competition /State aid

The step under review	Reform Agenda step No. 22: E-case management system is operational and forensic IT tools are used for inspections, in order to improve the capacities of the National Competition Authority to carry out relevant investigations procedures concerning Competition Law infringements.
Description	The e-case management system includes also the possibility to manage all internal documents of the Competition authority, including the management of the cases initiated by the Competition Council. The forensic IT tools are integrated in the internal processes of the Competition Council and used for inspections. The forensic tools should correspond to the tools used by the Competition authorities from EU Member States.
Baseline	In 2024, no case management system in place and no forensic IT tools are in use.
Deadline of the step	30 June 2026
Commission assessment of results	**E-case management** The Competition Council has established and operationalised the Information System for Document Management and Electronic Case Management (SMDDA), designed for the electronic management of documents and administrative and investigation case files. The SMDDA functionalities include management of incoming and outgoing documents, the creation and administration of electronic case files, the management of procedural activities, and the use of workflows related to preliminary examinations, merger notifications, State aid notifications, market studies and investigations. Activities were carried out to configure the organisational structure, the user roles and access rights, institutional-specific nomenclators and classifiers, as well as workflow processes related to the management of administrative and investigation documents and case files. Mechanisms were also configured for integrating the tool with the government services MPass and MSign, as well as for the automated receipt and registration of electronic correspondence. Access to SMDDA is ensured through nominal authentication, with integration mechanisms configured for the government service MPass, as confirmed by the Electronic Governance Agency. **Forensic tools** The Competition Council has established the technical infrastructure and developed the institutional capacity for the use of digital forensic tools in inspection and investigation activities to strengthen its

	capacity to carry out relevant investigation procedures concerning Competition Law infringements. This includes the technical infrastructure necessary for the collection, preservation, processing, and analysis of digital evidence used in inspections and investigations. The functional requirements and technical specifications for the digital forensic infrastructure and tools were defined following the recommendations of an EU Twinning project ensuring that the new tools correspond to those used by the competition authorities in EU Member States. The use of forensic tools is firmly grounded in Competition Law No 183/2012. These tools enable the Competition Council to exercise its statutory inspection powers in practice, and their use does not depend on the adoption of separate internal guidance. The digital forensic software solutions and the hardware equipment required for the operation of the digital forensics laboratory were procured in March-May 2026. The operationality of digital forensic tools was demonstrated through practical exercises involving extraction, processing, and analysis of digital data. Capacity building on digital forensics for the Competition Council staff included dedicated training in June 2025 and a certification by the European Union Agency for Law enforcement training (CEPOL) in June 2026. Currently, the e-case management system and the forensic tools are operational and in use, even if no cases/files have been yet completed.
Conclusion of the review of the step by the beneficiary	The beneficiary considers the step to be satisfactorily fulfilled.
Checks performed and evidence used in the verification of the step and related findings	1. Competition Law No. 183/2012, published on 15 September 2023 in the Official Gazette No. 351–354, Article 620: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/2776/part/1#page=1 2. Contract No. 11 of 30 March 2026 for the development and implementation of the Information System for Document Management and Electronic Case Management (SMDDA); 3. Report on the implementation of the Information System for Document Management and Electronic Management of Investigation Case Files (SMDDA) and the demonstration of its functionalities, submitted to Commission in July 2026; 4. Confirmation of the integration of the SMDDA with the Government services MPass and MSign in the test environment, issued by the Electronic Governance Agency on 10 June 2026.

	5. Screenshots and video recordings demonstrating the implemented functionalities and the use of the SMDDA. 6. Contract of 23 March 2026 for the procurement of the digital forensic software solutions OpenText EnCase Forensic and Cellebrite; 7. Procurement contracts related to the equipment of the digital forensics laboratory (notebooks, workstation-type computer, IT equipment and accessories); 8. Report on functional testing and operational validation of the digital forensic tools available in the Competition Council, July 2026; 9. Certificates of participation in the CEPOL programme "Cyber Lab Training: Mobile Forensics", held on 8–12 June 2026 in Chisinau, Moldova; 10. Mission report of the EU Twinning project on the development of the Competition Council's capacities in the field of digital forensics and the use of digital forensic tools in investigations, dated September 2025; 11. Lists of participants of the training sessions on the use of digital forensic tools organised under the EU Twinning project, held on 17 and 19 September 2025. 12. Competition Council note on the legal and operational framework for the use of digital forensic tools by the Competition Council, July 2026.
Double funding	Contributions from third parties in support of the fulfilment of this step were reported as follows: technical assistance and expertise under the Twinning Project, the "Moldova is Europe" initiative, and CEPOL programmes. These contributions consisted exclusively of technical expertise and training. The results were delivered by the Moldovan government.
Clear conclusion on the achievement of the step	**Satisfactorily fulfilled**

Pillar 1 – Private sector development

Reform: Improve Research and Innovation capacities in the priority areas of Smart Specialisation Strategy

The step under review	Reform Agenda step No. 32: Research and Innovation (R&I) capacities are strengthened through the implementation of the national Smart Specialization Strategy, with award of R&I infrastructures programmes, collaborative public-private partnership

	for research and innovation activities and innovation vouchers, and technology transfer programmes.
Description	In line with the National Smart Specialisation Strategy "Smart Moldova 2024-27", Moldova is to launch: (i) at least four collaborative research and innovation activities and four innovation vouchers, and (ii) at least four R&I infrastructure programmes (strengthening existing R&I laboratories, hubs or units/departments in public research performing organisations, including in higher education institutions) and (iii) at least four technology transfer programmes.
Baseline	In 2024, the Programme "Smart Moldova" was approved but the implementation has not started. It aims at aligning research, technological development, and innovation with economic sectors, enhancing resource efficiency and prioritising investments in those sectors in which Moldova has a potential competitive advantage. Four priority areas are identified: 1. Agriculture and food processing; 2. Information and Communication Technology; 3. Sustainable Energy; 4. Biomedicine and biopharmaceuticals.
Deadline of the step	30 June 2026
Commission assessment of results	In accordance with the implementation plans of the National Smart Specialisation Strategy "Smart Moldova" 2024-2027, approved by Government Decision No. 588/2024 on 28 August 2024, the National Agency for Research and Development (NARD) launched the following calls for proposals: **(i) Research and innovation activities and innovation vouchers** **Research and innovation activities** On 4 March 2026, Moldova launched a demonstration project call for proposals under the "Smart Moldova" initiative for 2026-2027 with a total budget of MDL 5 million). Out of nine project proposals submitted, four collaborative research and innovation projects were approved for funding on 18 June 2026. **Innovation vouchers** Through Order No. 09-PC, the call for proposals for innovation vouchers for 2025 was launched on 19 February 2025 with a total budget of MDL 1 million. Out of twelve proposals submitted, five were approved for funding on 5 September 2025. Through Order No. 03-PC, the 2026 call for proposals for innovation vouchers was launched on 12 March 2026. Five proposals were approved for funding on 28 May 2026 and on 18 June 2026. **(ii) R&I infrastructure programmes**

	Through Order No. 01-PC the call for proposals for R&I infrastructure programmes/projects was launched on 30 January 2026 with a total budget of EUR 9.5 million. The call supported the strengthening of R&I infrastructure, including modernisation and upgrading of existing research facilities in public research performing organisations, including higher education institutions. A total of 15 project proposals were submitted and went through the eligibility assessment and evaluation, with results published on the NARD website. In total, 11 proposals were selected and approved for funding through Order No. 1210 of 26 June 2026. **(iii) Technology transfer programmes** Order No. 31-PC was approved on 15 September 2025 and the call for proposals for innovation and technology transfer projects was launched on 2 October 2025. The call took place in two stages with a total budget of MDL 35 million. In Stage I, the Expert Evaluation Committee selected 15 projects that went through the eligibility assessment and evaluation, with the results published on 2 March 2026. During Stage II, eight projects were approved for funding through Order No. 05-PC of 28 May 2026 and published on the NARD website.
Conclusion of the review of the step by the beneficiary	The beneficiary considers the step to be satisfactorily fulfilled.
Checks performed and evidence used in the verification of the step and related findings	1. Public consultation for the call on the National Agency for Research and Development website published on 16 February 2026: https://ancd.gov.md/ro/press-releases/dezbaterea-publica-asupra-pachetului-de-informatii-privind-concursul-proiecte-de 2. Order of the National Agency for Research and Development No. 02-PC on the organisation of the call for proposals, published on 4 March 2026: https://old.ancd.gov.md/sites/default/files/document/attachments/Ordinul%20nr.%2002-PC.pdf 3. Call for proposals for competition projects for the development and implementation of smart specialization solutions in the fields of SART Moldova, published on 4 March 2026: https://ancd.gov.md/ro/press-releases/concursul-proiecte-de-dezvoltare-si-implementare-solutiilor-de-specializare 4. Announcement of the eligibility assessment results, published on 6 May 2026: https://ancd.gov.md/ro/press-releases/eligibilitatea-proiectelor-depuse-la-concursul-proiecte-de-dezvoltare-si

	5. Press release on the extension of the submission deadline, published on 6 May 2026: https://ancd.gov.md/ro/press-releases/prelungirea-perioadei-de-depunere-proiectelor-la-concursul-smart-moldova-apelul-1 6. Results of the evaluation of the submitted project proposals, published on 9 June 2026: https://ancd.gov.md/ro/press-releases/rezultatele-expertizei-individuale-propunerilor-de-proiecte-aplicate-concursul-0 7. Order of the National Agency for Research and Development No. 08-PC approving funding for four projects, published on 18 June 2026: https://old.ancd.gov.md/sites/default/files/document/attachments/Ordinul%20Nr.%2008-PC%20din%2018.06.2026.pdf 9. Order of the National Agency for Research and Development No. 09-PC on 19 February on the organization and conduct of the innovation vouchers contest for the year 2025, published on NARD website: https://ancd.gov.md/sites/default/files/document/attachments/Ordin%2009-PC%20Vouchere%20Inovationale.pdf 10. Call for proposals for innovation vouchers for 2025, published on 19 February 2025 on NARD website: https://ancd.gov.md/ro/press-releases/concursul-de-proiecte-vouchere-inovationale-pentru-anul-2025 11. Eligibility assessment results published on 8 July 2025 on NARD website: https://old.ancd.gov.md/ro/content/rezultatele-examin%C4%83rii-eligibilit%C4%83%C8%9Bii-propunerilor-de-proiecte-la-concursul-%E2%80%9Evouchere 12. Results of the evaluation by the Expert Evaluation Committee published on 21 August 2025 on NARD website: https://old.ancd.gov.md/ro/content/rezultatele-evalu%C4%83rii-propunerilor-de-proiecte-%C3%AEn-cadrul-concursului-%E2%80%9Dvouchere-0 13. Order of the National Agency for Research and Development No. 25-PC of 5 September 2025 regarding the approval of the volume of budget allocations for the year 2025 intended for projects within the framework of the competition “Innovation Vouchers 2025-2026: https://ancd.gov.md/sites/default/files/document/attachments/25%20PC%20-%20VI.pdf 14. Public consultation materials on the innovation voucher call for 2026 published on 25 February 2026:

	https://ancd.gov.md/ro/press-releases/agentia-nationala-pentru-cercetare-si-dezvoltare-anunta-lansarea-dezbatere-publica 15. Order of the National Agency for Research and Development No. 03-PC on the organisation of the call for proposals, published on 12 March 2026: https://ancd.gov.md/sites/default/files/document/attachments/03%20Vouchere%20%20la%20schimb_compressed.pdf 16. Launch of the second call for proposals for innovation vouchers for 2026, published on 12 March 2026: https://ancd.gov.md/ro/press-releases/agentia-nationala-pentru-cercetare-si-dezvoltare-anunta-lansarea-concursului 17. Announcement of the eligibility assessment results, published on 6 May 2026: https://ancd.gov.md/ro/press-releases/eligibilitatea-pentru-concursul-de-proiecte-vouchere-inovationale-pentru-anul-2026 18. Order of the National Agency for Research and Development No. 04-PC approving funding for two projects published on 28 May 2026: https://old.ancd.gov.md/sites/default/files/document/attachments/Ordin%2004PC.pdf 18. Order of the National Agency for Research and Development No. 11-PC approving funding for three projects, published on 18 June 2026: https://old.ancd.gov.md/sites/default/files/document/attachments/Ordinul%20Nr.11-PC%2018.06.2026%20.pdf 19. Order of the National Agency for Research and Development No. 01-PC of 30 January 2026 on the organisation of the call for proposals, published on NARD website: https://old.ancd.gov.md/sites/default/files/document/attachments/Ordinul%20nr.%2001-PC.pdf 20. Call for proposals, published on the National Agency for Research and Development Website on 30 January 2026: https://ancd.gov.md/ro/press-releases/apel-pentru-propuneri-de-subproiecte-privind-infrastructura-de-cercetare 21. Announcement of the eligibility assessment results, published on the NARD website on 10 June 2026: https://ancd.gov.md/ro/press-releases/rezultatele-evaluarii-conformitatii-administrative-pentru-competitia-subproiecte 22. Order of the Ministry of Education and Research No. 1210 of 26 June 2026 approving the results of the Call for Research Infrastructure Subproject Proposals implemented under the Moldova Higher Education Project, as well as the list of subprojects selected for funding: https://ancd.gov.md/ro/press-

releases/rezultatele-concursului-subproiecte-privind-infrastructura-de-cercetare

23. Launch of the public consultation, published on NARD website on 17 September 2025: https://ancd.gov.md/ro/press-releases/dezbatere-publica-privind-pachetul-de-informatii-pentru-concursul-de-proiecte-0
24. Order of the National Agency for Research and Development No. 31-PC of 15.09.2025 on the organisation of the call for proposals, published on NARD website on 15 September 2025:
25. Call for proposals for technology transfer for 2026-2027 and the terms of reference, published on NARD website on 2 October 2025: https://ancd.gov.md/ro/press-releases/concursul-de-proiecte-transfer-tehnologic-pentru-anii-2026-2027
26. Announcement on the extension of the submission deadline for the call for proposals for phase I of the technology transfer projects, published on NARD website on 20 January 2026: https://ancd.gov.md/ro/press-releases/prelungirea-etapei-i-proiectelor-de-transfer-tehnologic-2026-2028-cadrul
27. Announcement of the eligibility assessment results for the submitted project proposals, published on NARD website on 29 December 2025: https://old.ancd.gov.md/ro/content/rezultatele-examin%C4%83rii-eligibilit%C4%83%C8%9Bii-propunerilor-de-proiecte-la-concursul-%E2%80%9Dproiecte-de
28. Announcement of the eligibility assessment results following the extension of the submission deadline (no additional project proposals were submitted during the extended period), published on NARD website on 12 February 2026: https://ancd.gov.md/ro/press-releases/comunicare-privind-etapa-prelungita-concursului-proiecte-de-transfer-tehnologic
29. Results of the evaluation of the preliminary project proposals by the Expert Evaluation Committee, published on NARD website on 2 March 2026: https://ancd.gov.md/ro/press-releases/rezultatele-evaluarii-propunerilor-preliminare-de-proiecte-cadrul-concursului
30. Announcement launching Stage II of the call, inviting the submission of full project proposals, published on NARD website on 2 March 2026: https://ancd.gov.md/ro/press-releases/concursul-transfer-tehnologic-2026-2027-etapa-ii
31. Announcement of the eligibility assessment results for the submitted project proposals, published on NARD website on 8 April 2026:

	https://ancd.gov.md/ro/press-releases/ancd-prezinta-lista-propunerilor-de-proiecte-detaliate-depuse-cadrul-concursului 32. Results of the individual expert evaluation of the submitted project proposals, published on NARD website on 4 May 2026: https://ancd.gov.md/ro/press-releases/rezultatele-expertizei-individuale-propunerilor-de-proiecte-aplicate-concursul 33. Results of the evaluation of the project proposals by the Expert Evaluation Committee for Stage II, published on the NARD website on 18 May 2026: https://ancd.gov.md/ro/press-releases/rezultatele-finale-ale-concursului-transfer-tehnologic-pentru-anii-2026-2027 34. Order of the National Agency for Research and Development No. 05-PC of 28.05.2026 on the validation and approval of projects for funding, published on NARD website on 28 May 2026 https://old.ancd.gov.md/sites/default/files/document/attachments/Ordin%2005PC.pdf
Double funding	Contributions from third parties in support of the fulfilment of this step were reported. They are linked to the research infrastructure subprojects that are financed under the loan agreement concluded between Moldova and the IBRD, acting on behalf of and as the implementing support agency for the Global Concessional Financing Facility, in the amount of EUR 9.5 million. The results were delivered by the Moldovan government.
Clear conclusion on the achievement of the step	**Satisfactorily fulfilled**

Pillar 2 – **Connectivity and digital infrastructure**

Reform: Enhancing connectivity through telecommunications and digital infrastructure

The step under review	Reform Agenda step No. 40: Speed and infrastructure sharing of digital connectivity are improved through the implementation of the EU Electronic Communications Code.
Description	(i) A modern regulatory framework is established facilitating the roll-out of high-speed and affordable electronic communications networks and services, in line with the EU Electronic Communications Code and EU Roaming Regulation; (ii) Legislation is approved to ensure consistent enforcement of the EU Electronic Communications Code and the remaining EU roaming acquis, including the EU roaming regulation, roaming implementation regulation, delegated act on termination rates, BEREC regulation;

	(iii) Incumbent operator shares its network, prices for deployment are decreased in line with EU Gigabit Infrastructure Act. (iv) Broadband Mapping System is implemented to enable accurate monitoring of internet coverage, quality of service, and infrastructure availability, and supporting targeted investment strategies.
Baseline	Regulatory framework partially aligned with the EU Communications Code (L 28/2016, L 241/2007).
Deadline of the step	30 June 2026
Commission assessment of results	**(i/ii) Electronic communications code and adoption of the roaming acquis (primary and secondary legislation)** Moldova harmonised its primary legislation transposing the EU Electronic Communications Code and parts of the Roaming Regulation. Law No. 72/2025 on Electronic Communications entered into force on 1 January 2026, alongside other provisions relevant to the electronic communications acquis. It also amended its secondary legislation to align with the remaining EU roaming *acquis,* including parts of the Roaming Regulation, roaming implementing regulation, delegated act on termination rates, and the BEREC regulation. The European Commission assessed that the adopted legislation correctly transposed the entirety of the EU Roaming *acquis.* It is on that basis that Moldova joined the EU's Roam like at home on 1 January 2026. All this alignment facilitates the roll-out of higher speed connectivity options and affordable electronic communications networks and services. **(iii) Operators sharing their networks** The updated tariffs for access to infrastructure entered into force on 1 March 2026. The reference offer containing the updated tariffs has been published on the incumbent operator's website. A comparison of the VAT-exclusive tariffs applicable before and from 1 March 2026 shows reductions ranging from 16% to 49%, depending on the cable diameter. Regarding the sharing of infrastructure, on 11 June 2026, Moldova adopted Law No. 106 on Access of Public electronic communications network providers to property and the use of infrastructure, transposing the EU's Gigabit Infrastructure Act (Regulation (EU) 2024/1309). **(iv) Broadband mapping system** The National Regulatory Agency for Communications of the Republic of Moldova (ARCOM) operates a public platform covering fixed and mobile broadband across Moldova (https://harta.arcom.md/#/home). Since 2025, the platform has been expanded to cover additional functionalities including fixed-

	broadband subscriptions and providers by locality and technology, together with mobile-coverage and signal-quality data by technology, provider, service type and measurement year. For this purpose, ARCOM enhanced the platform software and populated the platform with relevant additional data. In addition, Moldova has operationalised a new VHCN (Very High Capacity Networks) Map. The ARCOM, the Agency for Geodesy, Cartography and Cadastre, and the national cadastre of real estate entered into a trilateral agreement on 18 March 2026, sharing spatial datasets and network services, thus providing the foundation for the VHCN map. ARCOM's VHCN map is populated with data from Moldova's three mobile network operators (Orange Moldova, Moldcell and Moldtelecom) and provides granular information at locality, building, 100 x 100 m grid and network-cell level to support monitoring and targeted investment planning. Furthermore, the map has been populated with fixed internet data provided by the six largest operators, which cumulatively account for over 93% of active connections. The two platforms provide relevant monitoring of internet coverage, quality of service, and infrastructure availability, thus providing relevant information for digital investment decisions. Regarding internet speed and fixed-broadband connections, market data show that the number of fixed-broadband connections increased by 6.9% from Q1 2025 to Q1 2026, reaching 968 002. Of these, 947,178 connections (97.8%) used FTTx access technologies, while 75% of all fixed-broadband connections were subscribed to speed tiers of at least 100 Mbps. Higher fibre penetration is associated with higher download speeds. According to the Ookla Speedtest Global Index, between June 2025 and June 2026, Moldova's median download speed increased from 146.10 Mbps to 193.00 Mbps for fixed-broadband - a 32.1% increase, and from 54.25 Mbps to 73.05 Mbps for mobile broadband - a 34.7% increase.
Conclusion of the review of the step by the beneficiary	The beneficiary considers the step to be satisfactorily fulfilled.
Checks performed and evidence used in the verification of the step and related findings	1. Law No. 72 on Electronic Communications, published on 13 May 2025 in the Official Gazette No. 226–228, Article 266: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3080/part/1#page=1 2. Law No. 81 of 17 April 2025 on the Regulation of Roaming Services between the Republic of Moldova and the Member States of the European Union, published on 8 May 2025 in the Official Gazette No. 215–222, Article 259:

	https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3077/part/1#page=1 3. Law No. 144 of 19 June 2025 amending certain normative acts (support for the digital economy and electronic services, published on 20 June 2025 in the Official Gazette No. 328, Article 374: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3110/part/1#page=10 4. European Council Decision adopted on 25 July 2025: EU mobile roaming benefits extended to Moldova and Ukraine as of 2026. 5. Government Decision No. 693/2025 on the amendment and repeal of certain Government Decisions (aligning the secondary legislative framework with Law No. 72/2025 on Electronic Communications), published on 21 October 2025 in the Official Gazette: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3169/part/2#page=69 6. Government Decision No. 316/2025 approving the Regulation on specifying the characteristics of small-area wireless access points, published on 3 June 2025 in the Official Gazette: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3098/part/2#page=2 7. Order of the Ministry of Economic Development and Digitalisation N. 185 of December 2025 approving the List of Moldovan Standards adopting harmonised European standards and specifications for electronic communications networks and services, as well as associated infrastructure and services, published on 30 December 2025 in the Official Gazette: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3219/part/3#page=1 8. Decision No. 16 of 2 June 2025 of the Board of Administration establishing the Detailed Rules for the Implementation of the Provisions of Law No. 81/2025 on the Regulation of Roaming Services between the Republic of Moldova and the Member States of the European Union, published on 5 June 2025 in the Official Gazette: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3100/part/3#page=71 9. Government Decision No. 17 of June 2025 of the Board of Administration establishing detailed rules for the implementation of the fair use policy and the methodology for assessing the sustainability of the provision of retail roaming services at domestic retail prices, as well as the application to be submitted by roaming

	service providers for that assessment, published on 5 June 2025 in the Official Gazette: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3100/part/3#page=71 10. Decision No. 19 of 2 June 2025 of the Board of Administration on the implementation of the Working Arrangements between the National Regulatory Agency for Electronic Communications and Information Technology (ANRCETI) and the Body of European Regulators for Electronic Communications (BEREC): https://www.anrceti.md/files/filefield/DCA%2019%20din%2002.06.2025_ro%20.pdf 11. Decision No. 44 of 17 November 2025 of the Board of Administration approving the National Numbering Plan of the Republic of Moldova, published on 20 November 2025 in the Official Gazette: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3179/part/3#page=42 12. Decision No. 46 of 17 November 2025 of the Board of Administration approving the General Licence Conditions for the Use of Numbering Resources under the National Numbering Plan of the Republic of Moldova, published on 20 November 2025 in the Official Gazette: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3179/part/3#page=43 13. Decision No. 47 of 17 November 2025 of the Board of Administration amending Decision No. 126/2009 of the Board of Administration of ANRCETI on the establishment of the categories of radio frequencies and radio equipment whose use is permitted without obtaining a licence or technical permit, published on 17 November 2025 in the Official Gazette: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3179/part/3#page=44 14. Decision No. 50 of 9 December 2025 of the Board of Administration approving the Regulation on the Organisation and Functioning of the National Regulatory Agency for Electronic Communications and Information Technology, published on 11 December 2025 in the Official Gazette: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3190#page=104 15. Decision No. 3 of 29 January 2026 of the Board of Administration approving the Regulation on the General Authorisation Procedure and the Establishment and Amendment of the Conditions for the Provision of Electronic Communications Networks and/or Services under the General Authorisation Regime,

	published on 12 February 2026 in the Official Gazette: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3229/part/3#page=2 16. Decision No. 17 of 10 April 2026 of the Board of Administration establishing the Conditions and Procedures for the Granting, Amendment, Transfer, Revocation and Suspension of Rights of Use for Radio Frequencies, published on 17 April 2026 in the Official Gazette: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3261/part/3#page=43 17. Decision No. 4 of 29 January 2026 of the Board of Administration approving the Procedures and Conditions for the Granting, Reservation, Transfer, Suspension and Revocation of Rights of Use for Numbering Resources, published on 12 February 2026: in the Official Gazette: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3229/part/3#page=16 18. Decision No. 10 of 9 February 2026 of the Board of Administration approving the Roadmap for Radio Frequency Spectrum Management for the Development of Terrestrial Broadband Electronic Communications Networks and Services for the Period 2026–2030, published on 13 February 2026 in the Official Gazette: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3230/part/3#page=13 19. Decision No. 25 of the Board of Administration approving the Regulation on the Management of the National Top-Level Domain, published on 25 June 2026 in the Official Gazette: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3291/part/3#page=14 20. Law No. 106 of 11 June 2026 on the Access of Public Electronic Communications Network Providers to Property and the Use of Infrastructure, published in the Official Gazette No. 246–249, Article 254, on 16 June 2026: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3283/part/1#page=12 21. The reference offer containing the updated tariffs as of March 2026: https://backend.moldtelecom.md/files/OFERTA%20DE%20REFERINTA%20PENTRU%20Acces_la_CANALIZATIE_2026.pdf 22. Hyperlink to the broadband coverage mapping system: https://harta.arcom.md/#/home

	23. Report on the new broadband coverage mapping system, prepared by ARCOM, July 2026 24. The trilateral agreement between the national institution in charge of electronic communications, ARCOM, the Agency for Cartography, Geodesy and Cadastre and the Cadastre of Real Estate, registered on 18 March 2026 25.Screenshots of the data tables of three operators (Moldcell, Moldtelecom and Orange Moldova) relevant for the new broadband mapping system, prepared in July 2026 26. Ookla Speedtest Global Index, Median Country Speeds updated, data for Moldova, year-on-year comparison (June 2025 to June 2026): https://www.speedtest.net/global-index/moldova#fixed 27. ARCOM's Statistical report on electronic communications Q1 2026: https://www.anrceti.md/files/filefield/Raport%20CE%20tr.I%202026.pdf 28. Decision No 1/2025 of the EU-Republic of Moldova Association Council of 4 August 2025 as regards the further market opening with respect to the sector of roaming on public mobile communications networks and amending Annex XXVIII-B (Rules applicable to telecommunication services) to the Association Agreement between the European Union and the European Atomic Energy Community and their Member States, of the one part, and the Republic of Moldova, of the other part [2025/2020]: https://eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/dec/2025/2020/oj
Double funding	Contributions from third parties in support of the fulfilment of this step were reported but the results were delivered by the Moldovan government.
Clear conclusion on the achievement of the step	**Satisfactorily fulfilled**

Pillar 3 - Economic governance

Reform: Strengthened budgeting, expenditure controls and execution for better budgetary planning and policy implementation

The step under review	Reform Agenda step No.46: The legal obligation to regularly review all budgetary spending over at most seven years is introduced and methodology is adopted.

Description	The law is adopted to ensure that all budgetary spending is subject to regular review over at most seven years. The law includes provisions on: (i) endorsement and publication of spending reviews; (ii) inclusion of recommendations in the spending reviews; and (iii) identification of a timeline and responsible entities for their implementation. Methodology for spending reviews is adopted.
Baseline	No legal provision requiring regular spending reviews is in place.
Deadline of the step	30 June 2026
Commission assessment of results	Through amendments to Law No. 181/2014 on Public Finance and Budgetary-Fiscal Responsibility in December 2025, Moldova embedded spending reviews in its primary legislation. Article 21 requires each budgetary sector to be reviewed in terms of spending reviews at least once every seven years. The new legal provisions also require that spending reviews results are endorsed and published, and that the efficiency measures (recommendations) are integrated into the budgetary process. It also defines the role of the government and of the Ministry of Finance in the spending review process and provides the general timeframe to follow an annual cycle. In June 2026, Moldova adopted the methodology on the Budgetary Spending Review Process. The methodology established the organisational and analytical framework for conducting budgetary spending reviews, including its governance, detailed implementation timeline and the responsibilities of the institutions involved.
Conclusion of the review of the step by the beneficiary	The beneficiary considers the step to be satisfactorily fulfilled.
Checks performed and evidence used in the verification of the step and related findings	1. Law No. 327/2025 of 29 December 2025 amending certain normative acts (improving public financial management), published in the Official Gazette No. 665, Article 814, on 31 December 2025: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3208/part/1#page=9 2. Order No. 76 of 4 June 2026 of the Minister of Finance approving the Methodology on the Budgetary Spending Review Process: https://www.mf.gov.md/ro/content/proiectul-omf-%E2%80%9Ecu-privire-la-aprobarea-metodologiei-privind-procesul-de-revizuire

Double funding	Contributions from third parties in support of the fulfilment of this step were not reported.
Clear conclusion on the achievement of the step	**Satisfactorily fulfilled**

Pillar 3 – Economic governance

Reform: Public investment management system is transparent and rules based, with appraisal, budgeting and execution processes aligned with international best practices with improved capital investment execution.

The step under review	Reform Agenda step No. 50: Single national project pipeline is implemented for all funds with coherent and internally aligned requirements: (i) Only project proposals appraised in line with general rules for public investment management established in Regulation 684 and are deemed eligible are included in the mid-term budgetary framework and considered for funding by the annual budget. (ii) For Special Funds, all public capital investment project proposals above the minimum threshold established in Regulation 684 are submitted trough the Project Appraisal IT system and appraised according to the general rules on preparation and appraisal of capital investment projects.
Description	Legislation of special funds is amended to ensure that capital investment projects above the minimum threshold established in Regulation 684 follow Regulation 684 and are submitted under the Single Project pipeline. All capital investment projects of the Road fund, Regional Development fund and Environment fund above the minimum threshold established in Regulation 684 are integrated under the Single project pipeline.
Baseline	The 2025 Budget included 10 new projects: 2 eligible projects from the Project Pipeline and 8 projects under appraisal. As of December 2024, Special funds have own appraisal public investment management rules and do not go through the Single project pipeline approach.
Deadline of the step	30 June 2026
Commission assessment of results	**(i) Inclusion of investment projects into the medium-term budgetary framework and the annual budget** The 2026 State Budget adopted on 29 December 2025 included only new public capital investment projects that have been previously

	appraised under the Single Project pipeline (procedures established by Government Decision No. 684/2022) and have been confirmed as eligible for financing. Out of the 91 public capital investment projects included in the 2026 State Budget, 49 are eligible projects appraised in accordance with the Regulation through the Register of Public Capital Investment Project (SI RPIC) platform. The remaining 42 are ongoing projects initiated before the entry into force of Government Decision No. 684/2022 that do not fall under the new appraisal requirements. As to the inclusion of capital investment projects into the medium-term budgetary framework, no such framework was adopted in 2025 by the government. The framework for 2026-2029, was still in preparation by end June 2026 and thus no reporting was possible. **(ii) Projects under Special funds** The regulatory framework governing the three Special funds (the National Fund for Regional and Local Development, the National Environment Fund, and the Road Fund) was amended by Government Decision No. 304 of 11 June and Order No. 105 of 5 June 2026. The new provisions ensure that before being considered for financing, all future public capital investment projects exceeding the threshold of MDL 200 million established in the Government Decision No. 684/2022 are subject to the same appraisal requirements and are submitted through the Project Appraisal IT system under the single national project pipeline. The implementation of the new requirements for the three Special funds is at an early stage, as no new major projects exceeding the threshold had yet entered the appraisal process at the reporting date. Nevertheless, the necessary legal and institutional framework has been established, ensuring that all future eligible projects financed through these funds will be subject to the unified appraisal and selection mechanism.
Conclusion of the review of the step by the beneficiary	The beneficiary considers the step to be satisfactorily fulfilled.
Checks performed and evidence used in the verification of the step and related findings	1. Order No. 105 regarding the amendment of Order No. 170/2024 on Road Fund, published in the Official Gazette on 5 June 2026: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3279/part/3#page=9 2. Government decision No. 304 amending certain government decisions regarding the management of Development Funds, published on 11 June 2026 in the Official Gazette: https://www.legis.md/cautare/getResults?doc_id=154822&lang=ro

	3. List of eligible projects 2026 (annex 6 to State budget 2026), published on 25 December 2025: https://mf.gov.md/ro/content/bugetul-de-stat-2026 4. Minutes of the meeting of the Ministry of Finance Working Group on public capital investments of 2 April 2026 5. Minutes of the meeting of the Ministry of Finance Working Group on public capital investments of 8 April 2026.
Double funding	Contributions from third parties in support of the fulfilment of this step were not reported.
Clear conclusion on the achievement of the step	**Satisfactorily fulfilled**

Pillar 3– Economic governance

Reform: Strengthened external audit system and public internal and financial control

The step under review	Reform Agenda step No. 57: Legal amendments are adopted increasing budgetary independence of the Court of Accounts.
Description	Legal amendments to the Law on the Court of Accounts (CoA) and possibly other laws are adopted, to bring CoA legislation in line with international best practices and reducing the conflicting provisions in other laws. Legal provisions allow the CoA budget to be approved by the Parliament without the executive branch amending the draft law. Parliament procedures are adjusted accordingly.
Baseline	In 2024, The Supreme Audit Institution (SAI) of Moldova (Court of Accounts) enjoys limited budgetary independence. The financial independence of SAI is limited by Law 260/2017, which stipulates that the budget of the CoA is approved according to Law 181/2014 for independent/autonomous budgetary authorities. The CoA budget is elaborated and approved as the budget of each budgetary institution, sent and negotiated with the Ministry of Finance before being included in the draft annual budget law. According to SIGMA report on PAR 2023, some legal provisions conflict with CoA legislation.
Deadline of the step	30 June 2026
Commission assessment of results	The Court of Accounts Law No. 260/2017 was amended in June 2026 following extensive consultation with the European Commission, and with the support of SIGMA experts. The revised legal framework established a different budget adoption process for the Court of Account's budget to prevent any potential interference by the executive branch. Under the new process, the Parliament takes

	the final decision regarding the Court of Accounts budget, whereas the Ministry of Finance provides a reasoned opinion. In addition, the Parliament procedure was amended to ensure coherence with the new legal framework. The amendment explicitly assigns to the Committee on Economy, Budget and Finance the competence to examine the draft budget of the Court of Accounts and issue binding opinions on this.
Conclusion of the review of the step by the beneficiary	The beneficiary considers the step to be satisfactorily fulfilled.
Checks performed and evidence used in the verification of the step and related findings	1. Law No. 260/2017 on the organisation and functioning of the Court of Accounts of Moldova, amended on 16 June 2026, published in the Official Gazette: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3283/part/1#page=1 2. Parliament Decision No. 118/2026 amending Article 2 of Parliament Decision No. 315/2025 on the fields of activity of the standing parliamentary committees, published on 26 June in the Official Gazette: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3292/part/1#page=6
Double funding	Contributions from third parties in support of the fulfilment of this step were reported (OECD SIGMA providing technical assistance) but the results were delivered by the Moldovan government.
Clear conclusion on the achievement of the step	**Satisfactorily fulfilled**

Pillar 3 – Economic governance

Reform: Antifraud measures and protection of EU financial interests

The step under review	Reform Agenda step No. 64: In consultation with the European Commission services, strengthening the financial crime investigation system, by reviewing legal competences and increasing capacities of national specialized investigative bodies to proactively detect and investigate financial crimes and related illegal acts which impact the financial interests of Moldova and the EU.
Description	Legal amendments adopted. Competent authority(es) capacitated.
Baseline	Despite adequate regulatory framework financial crime investigations/persecutions are limited.

Deadline of the step	30 June 2026
Commission assessment of results	In June 2026, after extensive consultation with the European Commission, Moldova adopted Law No. 111/2026 on revising the criminal procedural legislation to strengthen the financial crime investigation system and to increase capacities of the national specialised investigative bodies, empowering the National Anti-corruption Centre (NAC) to proactively detect and investigate financial crimes and related illegal acts which impact the financial interests of Moldova and the EU. The law introduces a clearer division of responsibilities between the Anti-Corruption Prosecutor's Office (APO) and NAC. Under the new framework, NAC becomes the primary investigative authority for large-scale financial fraud, money laundering, serious economic crimes, and fraud involving public funds. APO, on the other hand, is to focus on high-level corruption involving senior public officials and lead the criminal prosecution in all cases investigated by NAC. This clearer allocation of competences reduces overlaps and facilitates the transfer of cases between institutions. As a result, the reform is expected to improve the efficiency, consistency and timing of investigations, while complex cases are investigated in a more coordinated manner. To support Law No. 111/2026, Moldova adopted Decision No. 124/2026 with a programme /action plan to implement the new legal provisions. This programme aims to ensure the effective functioning of the new institutional system through specific time-bound measures as well as the responsible stakeholders. Finally, in June 2026, Moldova adopted Parliament Decision No. 123/2026 and amended Parliament Decision No. 34/2026 to approve the organisational structure of NAC, increasing the institution's staff ceiling by 150 positions, from 359 to 509.
Conclusion of the review of the step by the beneficiary	The beneficiary considers the step to be satisfactorily fulfilled.
Checks performed and evidence used in the verification of the step and related findings	1. Law No. 111/2026 on the amendment of certain normative acts (strengthening the mechanisms for combating corruption, financial crime and organised crime), published in the Official Gazette on 24 June 2026, No. 273–276, Art. 265: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3290/part/1#page=1 2. Parliament Decision No. 123/2026 amending Parliament Decision No. 34/2016 approving the organisational structure and staff ceiling of the National Anticorruption Centre (increase of

	the NAC staff ceiling and amendment of its organisational structure), published in the Official Gazette on 30 June 2026, No. 288–290, Art. 293: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3294/part/1#page=22 3. Parliament Decision No. 124/2026 approving the National Programme for the Modernisation of the Investigation and Criminal Prosecution System in the Areas of Combating Corruption, Organised Crime, Financial Fraud, Money Laundering and Other Illicit Activities for 2026–2027, published in the Official Gazette on 30 June 2026, No. 288–290, Art. 294: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3294/part/1#page=24 4. State Budget Law No. 322/2025 for 2026 adopted on 29 December 2025 and published in the Official Gazette on 31 December 2025, Annex 5: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3204/part/1#page=21 5. National Anticorruption Centre Request No. 14/01-8001 of 4 May 2026 regarding the allocation of additional financial resources.
Double funding	Contributions from third parties in support of the achievement of this step were not reported.
Clear conclusion on the achievement of the step	**Satisfactorily fulfilled**

Pillar 3 – Economic governance

Reform: Making the SOE sector sustainable and financially viable

The step under review	Reform Agenda step No. 65: Investment profiles for 5 SOEs are elaborated and privatisation procedures are launched.
Description	The investment profile for five SOEs (out of ten classified for immediate privatisation) are elaborated and the privatisation procedure for them are launched. The Government Decision on the triage mechanism of SOEs covered the following: Category 1 - enterprises not suitable for privatisation – 66 SOEs; Category 2 - enterprises recommended for reorganisation in another legal form of organisation – 55 SOEs; Category 3 - enterprises deemed suitable for privatisation after reorganisation/restructuring - 10 SOEs; Category 4 - enterprises recommended for immediate privatisation – 10 SOEs; Category 5 - enterprises recommended for liquidation – 97 SOEs.

Baseline	Triage of SOEs was finalised in 2024 but its implementation has not started.
Deadline of the step	30 June 2026
Commission assessment of results	Investment profiles were prepared and, on 12, 19 and 26 June 2026 the privatisation procedures were launched for five state-owned enterprises (Chișinău Glass Factory, Hotel Zarea, Știința Editorial and Printing House, Lumina State Didactic Publishing House, and Izomer Experimental Chemical Enterprise) with the corresponding information bulletins published. These five SOEs are part of the ten enterprises classified for immediate privatisation, in line with the 2024 triage.
Conclusion of the review of the step by the beneficiary	The beneficiary considers the step to be satisfactorily fulfilled.
Checks performed and evidence used in the verification of the step and related findings	1. Investment Profile of the State-Owned Enterprise "Chișinău Glass Factory" 2. Investment Profile of the State-Owned Enterprise "Hotel Zarea" 3. Investment Profile of the State-Owned Enterprise "Știința" Editorial and Printing House 4. Investment Profile of the State-Owned Enterprise "Lumina" State Didactic Publishing House 5. Investment Profile of the State-Owned Enterprise "Izomer" Experimental Chemical Enterprise 6. Calls for privatisation Investment tender for the privatisation of the State-Owned Enterprise "Chișinău Glass Factory", published on 12 June 2026: https://app.gov.md/statul-lanseaza-concursul-investitional-pentru-privatizarea-i-s-fabrica-de-sticla-din-chisinau/ 7. Launch of the open tender for the privatisation of state-owned assets, including the SOE "Hotel Zarea", the SOE "Știința" Editorial and Printing House, and the SOE "Lumina" State Didactic Publishing House, published on 19 June 2026: https/app.gov.md/statul-anunta-desfasurarea-licitatiei-cu-strigare-pentru-privatizarea-bunurilor-proprietate-publica-de-stat/ 8. Launch of the open tender for the privatisation of the State-Owned Enterprise "Izomer" Experimental Chemical Enterprise, published on 26 June 2026: https://app.gov.md/statul-anunta-desfasurarea-licitatiei-cu-strigare-a-i-s-intreprinderea-experimentala-chimica-izomer/

Double funding	Contributions from third parties in support of the fulfilment of this step were not reported.
Clear conclusion on the achievement of the step	**Satisfactorily fulfilled**

Pillar 4 – Social capital

Reform: Strengthening education outcomes, quality and integrity of university education

The step under review	Reform Agenda step No. 80: Robust anticorruption and antifraud measures are implemented in universities, with the adoption of a single national plagiarism-detector software, and at least 50% of Bachelor students in HEIs having attended on-line or off-line trainings and awareness-raising campaigns on ethics and anti-plagiarism measures with the involvement of the National Anticorruption Centre.
Description	(i) The Ministry of Education uses a single software solution for anti-plagiarism in thesis and dissertations across all levels of higher education from bachelor to doctoral degrees. (ii) Moldova develops the normative and policy framework for integrity/anticorruption in higher education, in collaboration with the National Anticorruption Centre. (iii) Moldova installs a single advanced IT software for plagiarism detection in all HE institutions of the country and in the national quality assurance agencies, ensuring also inter-operability with the modules of the HEMIS (Higher Education Management Information System). (iv) Moldova develops and rolls out, in partnership with the National Anticorruption Centre, training modules (online and in-presence) for university students on ethics, transparency, integrity and has launched communication/awareness raising campaigns on academic integrity and the effect of corruption in higher education.
Baseline	In December 2024, no advanced antiplagiarism IT tools are in use in Moldovan universities and no regular training and awareness raising campaigns on academic integrity are conducted. Different universities use occasionally antiplagiarism software of different type, usually of low-quality performances and without the necessary continued maintenance. Also, a comprehensive normative and policy framework on academic integrity is missing.
Deadline of the step	30 June 2026

Commission assessment of results	(i/ iii) **Single software solution for anti-plagiarism** The Ministry of Education and Research signed a contract on 16 April 2026 with a private company for the provision of a digital platform for text similarity analysis and plagiarism detection for higher education institutions in Moldova for a duration of 12 months. Public procurement for anti-plagiarism detection services is to be done on an annual basis. The software is used at all levels of higher education according to Order No. 914 of 12 May 2026 approving the anti-plagiarism standards for higher education institutions. The software for plagiarism detection was made available to all 16 public and private higher education institutions. By June 2026, Moldovan entire network of all public and private high education institutions has been covered by the services of anti-plagiarism software and all 14 universities have used the software (network has been reduced from 16 to 14 due to reorganisation and consolidation efforts). The National Agency for Quality Assurance in Education and Research (ANACEC) also uses the anti-plagiarism software. Interoperability with HEMIS's (Higher Education Management Information System) modules is not fully ensured but data exchange is possible - the relevant data is imported manually from the data reports of the service provider to HEMIS. Whilst this constitutes a minimal substantive deviation from the requirement, the policy objective of this reform step is met. The objective circumstances linked to this minimum deviation are that the government chose to procure services of anti-plagiarism detection software, rather than procuring the software itself which is a more advanced approach allowing for a better quality of service. As public procurement is to take place annually, different service providers might be selected making continuous transfer of data to HEMIS difficult; thus the Ministry ensures data transfer in an alternative way. This minimal deviation does not change the nature of the measure and does not affect the progress towards achieving the reform that the step represents. (ii/ iv) **Integrity/anticorruption in higher education** On 20 October 2025, per Order No. 1790 of the Ministry of Education, a Working Group on anti-plagiarism software introduction was established that included a National Anti-corruption Centre representative. The normative and policy framework on academic integrity and anti-corruption in higher education has been strengthened as follows: • The Education Code of the Republic of Moldova No. 152/2024 was amended by Law No. 21/2026, introducing a dedicated

	article (Art. 107) on ensuring academic integrity and combating corruption in higher education; • The Framework Regulation on the organisation of bachelor's degree programmes and integrated higher education programmes based on the European Credit Transfer and Accumulation System (ECTS) was approved by Order No. 994 of 25 May 2026. • Government Decision No. 80/2022, approving the Regulation on the organisation and delivery of master's degree programmes, was amended by Government Decision No. 149/2026, introducing provisions to promote and ensure compliance with the principles of academic integrity throughout the learning, teaching and assessment processes. • Government Decision No. 616/2016, approving the methodology for the external quality evaluation of higher education, vocational education and training, and adult learning, was amended by Government Decision No. 133/2026 to incorporate academic integrity into the accreditation standards, requiring higher education institutions to implement clear policies and mechanisms for the prevention and handling of academic misconduct. • Government Decision No. 337/2026, approving the Framework Regulation on Academic Integrity in Higher Education Institutions, established the general framework and the minimum mandatory standards governing, among other, the principles of academic integrity and the responsibilities of higher education institutions and members of the academic community, measures to prevent breaches of academic integrity, and institutional mechanisms for ensuring academic integrity. • Order No. 914 of 12 May 2026 approved the anti-plagiarism standards for higher education institutions, including templates for reports and decisions. A study on academic integrity published in November 2025 was used to organise training sessions on ethics, transparency, integrity for bachelor's degree students across all higher education institutions. In accordance with the concept for the promotion of academic integrity in higher education, approved by Order No. 1979 of 18 November 2025, the ‘Ethics and academic integrity" course was developed and implemented in partnership with the National Anticorruption Centre. The course consists of 8 hours of instruction, structured into four modules, and includes theoretical components, academic case studies, practical exercises on citation and plagiarism detection, role-

	playing activities, and simulations on reporting corrupt practices. During the 2025–2026 academic year, 58% or around 27,000 students of all 46 700 bachelor students participated in online and in-person training programmes. As part of the campaign for the promotion of academic integrity in higher education, two national conferences were also organised in 2026 and raised awareness on academic integrity and corruption in higher education.
Conclusion of the review of the step by the beneficiary	The beneficiary considers the step to be satisfactorily fulfilled.
Checks performed and evidence used in the verification of the step and related findings	1. Public Procurement Contract No. 21571808, signed on 16 April 2026, between the Ministry of Education and Research and the company S.C. Plagiat-Sistem Antiplagiat prin Internet S.R.L. 2. Law No. 21/2026 amending the Education Code No. 152/2014, introducing provisions on academic integrity (Article 107¹), published in the Official Gazette on 6 March 2026: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3238/part/1#page=1 3. Government Decision No. 149/2026 amending Government Decision No. 80/2022 approving the Regulation on the organisation and delivery of master's degree programmes (Cycle II), requiring higher education institutions to promote and ensure compliance with the principles of academic integrity, published in the Official Gazette on 2 April 2026: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3253/part/2#page=22 4. Government Decision No. 133/2026 amending Government Decision No. 616/2016 approving the Methodology for the External Quality Evaluation of Higher Education, Technical Vocational Education and Training, and Adult Education, and the Regulation on the Calculation of Fees for Services Provided in the External Quality Evaluation of Study Programmes and Institutions of Technical Vocational Education, Higher Education, and Adult Education, published in the Official Gazette on 26 March 2026: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3249/part/2#page=28 5. Government Decision No. 337/2026 approving the Framework Regulation on Academic Integrity in Higher Education Institutions, published in the Official Gazette on 25 June 2026: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3291/part/2#page=2

	6. Order of the Ministry of education and research No. 994 approving the Framework Regulation on the Organisation of Bachelor's and Integrated Higher Education Programmes Based on the European Credit Transfer and Accumulation System (ECTS), published in the Official Gazette on 25 May 2026: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3293/part/3#page=4 7. Order of the Ministry of education and research No. 914/2026 approving the Anti-Plagiarism Standards for Higher Education Institutions, published in the Official Gazette on 15 June 2026: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3271/part/3#page=24 8. Order of the Ministry of education and research No. 1979 of 18 November 2025 on the organisation and implementation of events promoting academic integrity in higher education: https://mec.gov.md/sites/default/files/ordin_mec_nr._1979_din_18.11.2025_organizare_si_desfasuare_eveniment_de_promovare_a_integritatii_academice.pdf 9. Order of the Minister of education and research No. 658 of 7 May 2025, approving the sectoral anti-corruption plan for the education sector for 2025–2026: https://mec.gov.md/sites/default/files/ordin_aprobare_plan.pdf 10. Order of the Ministry of education and research No. 658 of 7 May 2025 approving the Report on the implementation of the Sectoral anti-corruption Plan for the education sector in 2025: https://mec.gov.md/sites/default/files/raport_privind_implementarea_in_anul_2025_a_planului_sectorial_anticoruptie_in_domeniul_educatiei_aprobat_prin_ordinul_ministrului_educatiei_si_cercetarii_nr._658_din_07.05.2025._1_2.pdf 11. Study on academic Integrity prepared by S.C. MAGENTA CONSULTING S.R.L, dated November 2025: https://mec.gov.md/sites/default/files/studiu_privind_integritatea_academica_2025_02.12.2025.pdf 12. National conference "Integrity is your choice!", held in Chișinău on 22 December 2025: https://mec.gov.md/ro/content/integritatea-academica-invatamantul-superior-fost-abordata-cadrul-unei-conferinte-nationale 13. National conference “Universities for the future”, held in Chișinău on 23 May 2025: https://mecc.gov.md/ro/content/universitati-pentru-viitor-eveniment-dedicat-invatamantului-superior-din-cadrul-saptamanii

	14. Lists of students who attended the "Ethics and Academic Integrity" training course, both in person and online. 15. Ministry of Education report on the results of anti-plagiarism check, published on 2 July 2026: https://mec.gov.md/sites/default/files/raport_mec_antiplagiat.pdf 16. Ministerial Order of the Ministry of Education and Research No. 1790 of 20 October 2025 on establishing of the Working Group.
Double funding	Contributions from third parties in support of the fulfilment of this step were not reported.
Clear conclusion on the achievement of the step	**Satisfactorily fulfilled**

Pillar 5 – **Green transition/natural capital**

Reform: Establishing the environmental playing field through modernising environmental governance and promoting low carbon development

The step under review	Reform Agenda step No. 93: Environmental regulatory and enforcement field is substantially strengthened with implementation of key functions of Ministry of Environment, the environmental inspectorate and environmental agency, enforcement of environmental control/regulation function, and functions arising from horizontal legislation Directives (including Environmental Impact Assessment, Strategic Environmental Assessment) ensuring relevant staffing for an effective implementation.
Description	Environmental Inspectorate: (i) A permanent fast response capacity to environmental incidents by the inspectorate is established – integrating eco-alert platform into the control system of the Environmental Inspectorate; (ii) Effective 24/7 year-round response capacity to environmental incidents is established together with a method for tracking the handling of environmental complaints –response staff is available, i.e. contracted on a 24/7 year around basis to register alerts; (iii) Rules to increase efficiency in response times to environmental complaints are adopted to ensure a maximum 24h response; (iv) Inspection results are transparent and publicly accessible (publishing anonymised inspection reports and acts); (v)Enforcement policy guidance document is adopted and made publicly available – control questionnaires and checklists developed;

	(vi) Inspection planning including development of clear risk categories, methodology for planning and holding inspections in line with EU standards is adopted. Legislation is adopted approving minimum criteria for Environmental Inspections. Environmental Agency: (i) Clarified competencies to ensure efficient environmental implementation and monitoring, permitting system; (ii) Mechanism to check self-monitoring reports is established; (iii) Methodologies for private sector reporting requirements are developed. Institutional mechanism for consultation of private sector is established; (iv) A unified, easily accessible, database of environmental permits is established and updated on a regular basis; (v) Responsibility for permits and monitoring of chemicals, GHG emissions has been assigned to Environmental agency; (vi) Environmental impact assessments are carried out for all major investments and strategic environmental assessments are carried out for all major plans and programmes; (vii) Agency approves the revised organisational chart, and minimum additional 40 staff members the Environmental Agency are hired. Ministry of Environment: (viii) Strategic environmental assessments are carried out for all major plans and programmes according to the provisions of the national SEA legislation.
Baseline	Lack of clear institutional framework with defined roles (e.g., missing competencies in chemicals management, not sufficient competencies to fully implement EIA, climate actions)
Deadline of the step	30 June 2026
Commission assessment of results	**For the Environmental Inspectorate:** **(i)** Permanent fast response capacity The permanent fast response capacity EcoAlert Platform where citizens can report environmental issues and incidents was established at ecoalert.md. Through a handover-receipt act of 11 May 2026, the EcoAlert Platform and the ecoalert.md domain were taken over by the Environmental Inspectorate to receive and manage the reports of environmental incidents. To ensure the functionality of the Platform and the relevant website, the Inspectorate signed a contract on 25 June 2026 with national Information Security and Cybersecurity Service creating the necessary technical and

	institutional capacities for receiving and managing notifications of environmental incidents. **(ii) Effective 24/7 year-round response capacity** The institutional framework necessary for the functioning of the 24/7 response mechanism, the Operational Centre for Environmental Response in 'Centre', 'North' and 'South' territories, was set up on 6 May 2026 through the Government Decision 229/2026. The organisational structure of the Environmental Inspectorate, the staffing division, job descriptions, functions and responsibilities for receiving and handling environmental alerts, coordinating response actions, and tracking the handling of environmental complaints were defined and approved on 12 June 2026 through the Order No. 40. Four full-time staff have been employed for an initial period of 6 months, and a call was published on 28 July 2026 to recruit 15 staff on permanent basis. **(iii) Quicker response time to environmental complaints** The regulation on the management of environmental alerts and the procedures for the registration, transmission, and tracking of handling and reporting of environmental complaints were adopted through Order No. 41 of 12 June 2026. The new regulatory framework prescribes that for operational interventions concerning critical-priority complaints, an operational report is to be prepared within 24 hours. The following mechanisms should help ensure compliance with the deadline: (i) Complaints are received 24/7 through a virtual operator; (ii) Each complaint is assigned a unique ID, and deadlines are automatically monitored through the information system; (iii) Actions taken and results achieved are recorded in the alerts/incidents register; (iv) Separate performance indicators are monitored for the "average response time" and the "average resolution time" and reported quarterly and annually. **(iv) Transparent and accessible inspection results** Anonymised environmental inspection reports as of April 2026 are published on the Environmental Inspectorate's website. **(v) Enforcement policy and checklists** The State Control Enforcement Policy guidance document was adopted on 3 June 2026 through Order No. 103. Sector specific inspection checklists and questionnaires were approved on 13 May 2026 through Order No. 77 and made publicly available on the Inspectorate's website. Additional sector specific guidance documents and questionnaires were adopted on 4 July 2025 through Order No. 101, on 4 June 2025 through Order No. 102 and on 19 June 2026 through Order No. 114. **(vi) Risk-based inspection planning**

	The regulatory framework for planning and doing environmental inspections has been approved including minimum criteria. The risk-based approach has been introduced which is in line with EU standards, following the principles of Directive 2010/75/EU on industrial emissions and the Recommendation of the European Parliament and the Council of 4 April 2001 Directive 2001/331/EC on the minimum criteria for environmental inspections in the Member States. Government Decision No 457/2025 of 16 July 2025 amended the methodology, in particular by updating the areas of control and revising risk criteria. It also approved the format of the Annual Control Plan and adjusted the process for analysing petitions and complaints. Order No. 79 of 20 November 2025 approved the Annual Plan of scheduled inspections for 2026 while Order No. 186 of 16 December 2025 approved the Action Plan of the Environmental Protection Inspectorate for 2026 developed in accordance with the newest methodology. In addition, the guidance document Policy on the Implementation of State Inspections was approved by the Environmental Inspectorate through Order No. 103 on 3 June 2026. It includes provisions requiring risk-based inspections. **For the Environmental Agency:** **(i) Clarified competencies** The Agency's role and competencies in the areas of permitting, environmental monitoring, the environmental impact assessment, chemicals management, air quality and the issuance of greenhouse gas emissions permits was defined on 9 April 2026, through Law No. 53/2026. **(ii) Verification of self-monitoring reports** Methodological guidelines for checking self-monitoring reports were approved on 25 June 2026 through Order No. 118. The guidelines established the mechanism and the methodological framework for the organisation, implementation, management, evaluation and reporting of environmental monitoring activities by operators of industrial and other economic activities. **(iii) Private sector reporting and consultation** One methodology for environmental reporting by private sector operators was approved on 25 June 2026 through Order No. 199. For greenhouse gas (GHG) emission, two methodologies were approved: Order No. 111 of 16 June 2026 on the guidelines for monitoring GHG emissions, and Order No. 113 of 18 June 2026 on the guidelines for the preparation of annual GHG emissions reports. The institutional mechanism for consulting the private sector was established in June 2026 through the creation of a Front Office/Help

	Desk Directorate in the Agency. The regulatory framework was adopted through Government Decision No. 227 of 6 May 2026 and Order 348-p of 8 June 2026. **(iv) Database of unified permits** A digital platform for environmental permits /permissive acts was launched on the Environmental Agency website in June 2026 ensuring accessibility and providing regular updates. **(v) Responsibility over chemicals and greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions** Responsibility for permits and monitoring of chemicals and GHG emissions was assigned to the Agency through Law No. 53/2026 of 9 April 2026. Law No. 243/2025 of 10 July 2025 integrated GHG permits into environmental permits and Government Decision No. 257/2026 of 20 May 2026 set verifier accreditation rules. **(vi) Environmental and strategic impact assessments under the mandate of the Environmental Agency** Between May 2025 and June 2026, all relevant cases (849) of major public and private investment projects eligible for environmental impact assessment (EIA) were examined and 508 files were pre-selected by the Agency in accordance with Law No. 86/2014. Out of these, nine projects underwent the full EIA procedure. All relevant cases (148) of major policy and planning documents at the local level eligible for a strategic environmental assessment (SEA), were processed and screened between May 2025 and June 2026, of which one assessment underwent a full SEA procedure. Both, pre-selected and assessed cases are presented in the Agency's registry. **(vii) Staffing and organisational restructuring** The Agency's revised organisational chart was approved through Order No. 330-p on 29 May 2026. Based on the staffing plan approved on 2 June 2026, recruitment procedures were initiated for the 40 additional positions allocated under Government Decision No. 227/2026, as well as for the positions taken over from the former Agency for Geology and Mineral Resources. A competition was launched on 4 June 2026. The number of positions filled by end June 2026 was 26. Due to absence of eligible candidates, authorities extended the initial call and launched a new call: the deadline for submitting applications was extended until 10 July 2026, while a new call was launched on 20 July 2026. By end-August 2026, the total number of additionally recruited staff reached the target of 40. **For the Ministry of Environment:** **(i) Strategic Environmental Assessments (SEA) under the mandate of the Ministry of Environment**:

	The SEA procedure is regulated by the provisions of Law No. 11/2017 and the guide on the performance of procedure on the SEA. Between May 2025 and June 2026, all relevant (12) major policy and planning documents at the national level were submitted by the central public authorities to the Ministry of Environment. The SEA was identified as mandatory only for one file, namely the Specialised Section "Water and Sanitation" of the National Spatial Planning Plan. Ministry of Environment's registry lists all pre-selected programmes and finally assessed programmes. For the staff of the Operational Centre for Environmental Response of the Environmental Inspectorate and for the additional 40 staff members the Environmental Agency, the authorities have credibly undertaken significant efforts to finalise the staff recruitments. Nonetheless, by the time of the adoption of this Decision, the staff of the Operational Centre remains employed on a temporary basis, instead of having permanent positions. Furthermore, while the Agency managed to recruit all the required 40 additional staff, 14 of the requirements were only finalised in August 2026. Whilst this constitutes a minimal substantive deviation from the requirement of the Commission Implementing Decision approving the Reform Agenda, the policy objective of this reform step is met. The objective circumstances linked to this minimum deviation are that the recruitment process has been influenced by external factors (i.e. availability of eligible candidates) and is thus not fully under the government's control. This minimal deviation does not change the nature of the measure and does not affect the progress towards achieving the reform that the step represents. On this basis, it is considered that these constitutive elements of the step are achieved. Evidence on extending the work contracts within the Operational Centre will need to be presented at the latest by December 2026 to avoid a situation in which the Commission can consider that the satisfactorily fulfilment of the step is reversed.
Conclusion of the review of the step by the beneficiary	The beneficiary considers the step to be satisfactorily fulfilled.
Checks performed and evidence used in the verification of the step and related findings	1. Letter and Handover Acceptance Act for the transfer of the EcoAlert Platform to the EPI. 2. Hand-over receipt act sent to the Information Technology and Cyber Security Service for the configuration of the EPI website to integrate the EcoAlert Platform. 3. Government Decision No. 229/2026 amending Government Decision No. 548/2018 on the approval of the Regulation on the organisation and functioning of the Environmental Protection

	Inspectorate on 6 May 2026, published on 14 May 2026 in the Official Gazette No. 206–209, Art. 245: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3270#page=58 4. Order of the Director of the Environmental Protection Inspectorate No. 40 of 12 June 2026 on the approval of the Regulation of the Operational Centre for Immediate Response to Environmental Alerts 5. Orders assigning staff to the Operational Centre (No. 186-p, 187-p, 188-p and 189-p) from 30 July 2026 6. Environmental Protection Inspectorate announcement regarding the conduct of the internal competition to fill vacant civil service positions within the Environmental Protection Inspectorate, published on the 28 July 2026. 7. Order of the Director of the Environmental Protection Inspectorate Order No. 41 of 12 June 2026 approving the Regulation on the management of environmental alerts: 8. Anonymised minutes/reports of environmental inspections, published on the Inspectorate's website: https://ipm.gov.md/ro/procese-verbale-intocmite-in-urma-controalelor 9. Order of the Minister of Environment No. 103 of 3 June 2026 approving the Policy on the Enforcement of State Control by the Environmental Protection Inspectorate: https://mediu.gov.md/sites/default/files/Ordin%20nr.103%20IPM_0.pdf 10. Order of the Ministry of Environment No. 77 of 13 May 2026 on the approval of the Checklists in the areas falling within the competence of the Environmental Protection Inspectorate, published on 29 May 2026 in the Official Gazette No. 227–230, Art. 407a: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3277#page=40 https://ipm.gov.md/upfiles/menu_files/Ordin_MM_Nr._77_din_13.05.2026.pdf 11. Order of the Ministry of Environment No. 114 of 19 June 2026 on the Approval of the Guidelines on the technical guidelines for State control of extractive waste facilities and reporting of information: : https://mediu.gov.md/sites/default/files/ORDINN%20114%20orientarile%20tehnice.PDF 12. Order No. 101 of 4 July 2025 of the Minister for the Environment, the Methodical Indications on the control of compliance with associated waste management obligations

	13. Order of the Minister of Environment no. 102 of 4 July 2025 approving the methodical indications regarding the environmental control over the activities of producers and importers of products subject to extended producer responsibility 14. Order of the Director of the Environmental Protection Inspectorate No. 79 of 20 November 2025 approving the Annual Plan of Scheduled Controls for 2026: https://ipm.gov.md/upfiles/menu_files/ordin%20nr.%2079%20din%2020.11.2025%20privind%20aprobarea%20Planului%20anual%20al%20controalelor%20planificate%20anul%202026.pdf 15. Government Decision No. 457 of 16 July 2025 amending certain Government decisions (state control planning), published on 21 August 2025 in the Official Gazette No. 441–444, Art. 516: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3144#page=30 16. Law No. 53/2026 amending certain normative acts (reform of the authorities subordinated to the Ministry of Environment), published on 25 April 2026 in the Official Gazette No. 183–185, Art150: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3264#page=4 17. Order of the Director of the Environmental Protection Inspectorate No. 79 of 20 November 2025 approving the Annual Plan of Scheduled Controls for 2026: https://ipm.gov.md/upfiles/menu_files/ordin%20nr.%2079%20din%2020.11.2025%20privind%20aprobarea%20Planului%20anual%20al%20controalelor%20planificate%20anul%202026.pdf 18. Order of the Director of the Environmental Protection Inspectorate No. 186 of 16 December 2025 approving the Action Plan of the Environmental Protection Inspectorate as a control authority for 2026: https://ipm.gov.md/upfiles/menu_files/Ordin%20MM_plan%20ac%C8%9Biuni%20IPM_organ%20de%20control_2026.pdf 19. Order No. 103 of the Minister of Environment dated 3 June 2026, includes provisions on planning inspections based on risk criteria. - https://mediu.gov.md/sites/default/files/Ordin%20nr.103%20IPM_0.pdf 20. Order of the Minister of Environment No. 119 of 25 June 2026 approving the Methodological Instruction on mandatory environmental reporting by private sector operators: https://mediu.gov.md/sites/default/files/Ordin%20Nr.119%20din%2025.06.2026.pdf

	21. Government Decision No. 227/2026 on the reorganisation of the Environmental Agency, published on 14 May 2026 in the Official Gazette No. 206–209, Art. 244: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3270#page=51 22. Order of the Director of the Environmental Agency No. 348-p of 8 June 2026 approving the regulations of the structural subdivisions of the Environmental Agency, Annex No. 3 — Regulation on the organisation and functioning of the "Front Office" and "Help Desk" Directorate. 23. Electronic platform containing the database of environmental permits (search tool): https://am.gov.md/ro Environmental permissive acts – public search – SIVAM – Agenția de Mediu - Acte permisive Agenția de mediu 24. Government Decision No. 257/2026 approving the Regulation on accreditation and the requirements applicable to greenhouse gas emissions verifiers, published on 25 May 2026 in the Official Gazette No. 224–226, Art. 277: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3276#page=18 25. Order of the Minister of Environment No. 111 of 16 June 2026 approving the Methodological Guide for the development of GHG emissions monitoring plans for installations and aviation activities: https://mediu.gov.md/sites/default/files/Ordin%20nr.%20111%20din%2016.06.2026.pdf 26. Order of the Minister of Environment No. 113 of 18 June 2026 approving the Methodological Guide for reporting GHG emissions for installations and aviation activities: https://mediu.gov.md/sites/default/files/Ordin%20nr.%20113%20din%2018.06.2026%20_Ghid%20RAE.pdf 27. Law No. 243/2025 amending certain normative acts, published on 22 August 2025 in the Official Gazette No. 445–447, Art. 612:https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3145#page=24 28. Register of environmental impact assessment files examined by the Environmental Agency: https://old.am.gov.md/ro/content/registrul-cererilor-%C8%99i-al-actelor-permisive-de-mediu-eliberate%C2%A0 29. Order No. 330-p of 29 May 2026 on the approval of the Organisational Chart of the Environmental Agency. https://am.gov.md/sites/default/files/media/documents/2026-07/260529%20Ord%20330%20Aprobarea%20Organigramei%20AM%20-%202_0.pdf

	30. 40 orders of Environmental Agency staff appointment/transfers/secondment. 31. Order No. 340-p of the Director of the Environmental Agency on the organisation of competition for vacant/temporary vacant public posts within the Environmental Agency for 50 vacant posts, adopted on 4 June 2026 with deadline for applications on the 30 June 2026 and the deadline further was extended until 10 July 2026 on the basis that not enough applications were received. 32. Order of the Director of the Environmental Agency No. 502-p of 17 July 2026 launching the competition for 31 vacant civil service positions on 20 July 2026 with the deadline for submission of application on the 6 August 2026. 33. Register of strategic environmental assessment consultation files for draft policy documents examined by the Ministry of Environment, published on the Ministry of Environment website: https://mediu.gov.md/ro/consultarea-proiectului-planuluiprogramului
Double funding	Contributions from third parties in support of the fulfilment of this step were reported through the Policy Advisory Fund project implemented by GIZ Moldova. Technical assistance was provided for the development of the draft regulatory concept governing the establishment and operation of the Operational Centre for Immediate Environmental Response, and for the preparation of the regulatory impact assessment related to the amendments to Government Decision on the organisation and functioning of the Environmental Inspectorate. These contributions consisted exclusively of technical expertise. While contributions from third parties were reported, the results were delivered by the Moldovan government.
Clear conclusion on the achievement of the step	**Satisfactorily fulfilled**

Pillar 5 – **Green transition/natural capital**

Reform: Environmental playing field through modernising environmental governance and promoting low carbon development

The step under review	Reform Agenda step No. 95: The enforceability of the new Law on Environmental Liability is ensured in line with Directive 2004/35/EC.
Description	(i) Legal framework necessary to comply with standards on environmental liability is established, including rules on

	penalties/fines applicable to infringements of the legal framework, as well as measures necessary for enforcement are applied. (ii) A clear methodology for damage assessment and financial environmental guarantee is established and criteria for remediating the damage as well as technical guidelines and assessment protocols for environmental authorities are approved. (iii) Entry into force of the Environmental Liability Law. (iv) Trainings are provided for inspectors and relevant personnel on damage assessment.
Baseline	Law on environmental liability and environmental liability practice currently not in place.
Deadline of the step	30 June 2026
Commission assessment of results	**(i) Legal framework to comply with standards on environmental liability** The necessary regulatory framework was established on 9 April 2026 through adoption of Law No. 53/2026. The legal provisions cover the implementation of environmental liability standards on the prevention and remedying of environmental damage by introducing the 'polluter pays' principle. Through the Code of Administrative Offences, fines for non-compliance have been introduced with preventive/ remedial measures or reporting obligations. Repeated offences may result in suspension of activities. Finally, as regards to enforcement arrangements, the Law clarifies the competencies of relevant public institutions, thereby strengthening the institutional and administrative framework for implementation and enforcement. The Environmental Agency is empowered to monitor compliance, apply penalties, and report to the Ministry of Environment, while the Inspectorate for Environmental Protection handles inspections. With this legal framework, Moldova has established a comprehensive legal framework in line with EU standards on environmental liability. **(ii) Methodology for damage assessment and financial environmental guarantee** Three new methodologies including technical guidelines for damage assessment, financial environmental guarantee, and the criteria for remediating were approved through Government Decisions No. 302/2026 and No. 303/2026 of 11 June 2026, and Order No. 112 of 18 June 2026. The latter also approved the assessment protocols for environmental authorities. **(iii) Law on Environmental Liability**

	Law No. 107/2025 on Environmental Liability on the prevention and remediation of environmental damage entered into force on 30 May 2026. **(iv) Training on damage assessment** Training for inspectors and staff on the assessment of environmental damage have been conducted throughout 2026. The first training was conducted on the 19 February 2026 on foundational aspects of environmental liability with a specific focus on methods and strategies for ensuring the implementation of legislation on the assessment of environmental damage. A total of 22 persons, including several inspectors and other relevant staff from the Environmental Agency, the inspectorate, the Ministry of environment and international experts participated. A second training was held on 16 June 2026 with 31 persons from the same authorities. The training focused on the methodology for damage assessment, financial security regulations, and the guide on assessment criteria.
Conclusion of the review of the step by the beneficiary	The beneficiary considers the step to be satisfactorily fulfilled.
Checks performed and evidence used in the verification of the step and related findings	1. Law No. 53/2026 on the amendment of certain normative acts concerning the reform of the authorities subordinated to the Ministry of Environment, No. 183–185 of 25 April 2026, Art. 150, published in the Official Gazette: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3264#page=4 2. Government Decision No. 302/2026 on the approval of the Methodology for assessing environmental damage, published in the Official Gazette on 18 June 2026, No. 250–253, Art. 317: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3284#page=68 3. Government Decision No. 303/2026 on the approval of the Regulation on the establishment and application of forms of financial security in the case of environmental damage, published in the Official Gazette on 18 June 2026, No. 250–253, Art. 318: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3284#page=74 4. Order of Minister of Environment No. 112 on the approval of the Guide on the procedure for applying the criteria for the assessment and remediation of environmental damage, published on 18 June 2026: https://mediu.gov.md/sites/default/files/Ordin%20MM%20112-18.06.26-Ghid%20aprobat.pdf

	5. Law No. 107/2025 on environmental liability on the prevention and remediation of environmental damage, published in the Official Gazette on 20 June 2025, No. 328, Art. 372: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3110/part/1#page=1 6. Training on the foundational aspects of environmental liability with a specific focus on the assessment of environmental damage, delivered on 20 February 2026. 7. Training on the assessment and remediation of environmental damage, delivered on 16 June 2026:https://mediu.gov.md/ro/comunicate-de-presa/daunele-de-mediu-vor-fi-evaluate-si-reparate-dupa-proceduri-noi 8. Signed list of participants, the training materials and presentation for both trainings.
Double funding	Contributions from third parties in support of the fulfilment of this step were reported but the results were delivered by the Moldovan government.
Clear conclusion on the achievement of the step	**Satisfactorily fulfilled**

Pillar 5 **– Green transition/natural capital**
Reform: Climate actions and decarbonisation

The step under review	Reform Agenda step No. 104: Moldova adopts relevant regulatory framework to align with the Energy Community MRVA (Monitoring, Reporting, Verification and Accreditation) Acquis.
Description	Moldova adopts relevant regulatory framework to align with the Energy Community MRVA *acquis* allowing for the implementation of the MRVA system to start in January 2027. This includes adjusting the regulatory framework on GHG permits, monitoring plans as well as specific requirements applicable to the accreditation of verifiers of emission reports. The regulatory provisions require for the covered installations to start monitoring their emissions from 1 January 2027, to submit their monitoring plans to the competent authority in 2026 or early 2027 and to report verified data by installation by end March 2028.
Baseline	As of April 2025, the regulatory framework for monitoring, reporting and verification system for GHG is not completed and the system is not operational.
Deadline of the step	30 June 2026

Commission assessment of results	Moldova has taken key steps to prepare for the operationalisation and start of the MRVA system starting from 1 January 2027, following the alignment with the Energy Community MRVA acquis. Law No 74/2024 on climate action introduced provisions related to greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions, monitoring plans, monitoring and reporting process and deadlines including integrated environmental permits issued for the approval of the activities that will need to include the component related to GHG emissions and the monitoring plan (Annex No. 1 to the Law). The law mandates operators of covered installations to hold integrated environmental permits or environmental permits issued by the Environmental Agency. The operators of the stationary installation's activities specified in Annex No. 1 to Law 74/2024 shall ensure the annual monitoring and reporting of GHG emissions, based on the approved greenhouse gas emissions monitoring plan. Government Decision 575/2024 of 21 August 2024 on the monitoring, reporting and verification of greenhouse gas emissions from stationary installations and aviation activities establishes the regulatory framework for monitoring and reporting of emissions, aligning with key provisions of EU Implementing Regulation 2018/2066. In addition, the Government Decision 257/2026 of 28 May 2026 on accreditation and the requirements applicable to GHG emissions verifiers establishes the legal framework for the accreditation and supervision of verifiers activities to ensure verification of annual reports on GHG emissions, transposing key provisions of the EU Implementing Regulation 2018/2067. Operators identified in energy installations, industrial installations and aviation sector need to submit annual emissions reports (RAE), with the first due by 31 March 2028, covering the previous calendar year. Methodological guidelines were also developed for the development of GHG emission monitoring plans for installations and aviation activities and for reporting on GHG emissions for installations and aviation activities.
Conclusion of the review of the step by the beneficiary	The beneficiary considers the step to be satisfactorily fulfilled.
Checks performed and evidence used in the verification of the step and related findings	1. Law No. 53/2026 on the amendment of certain normative acts concerning the reform of the authorities, published in the Official Gazette on 25 April 2026, No. 183-185 (10358-10360): https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3264#page=4

	2. Government Decision No. 257/2026 on the approval of the Regulation on accreditation and the requirements applicable to greenhouse gas emissions verifiers, published in the Official Gazette on 28 May 2026, No 224-226 (10399-10401): https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3276#page=18 3. Law No. 74/2024 of 11 April 2024 on Climate Action, published in the Official Gazette on 16 May 2024, No 209-212, Article 293: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/2901/part/1#page=1 4. Government Decision No. 575/2024 of 21 August 2024 on approving the Regulation on the monitoring, reporting and verification of greenhouse gas emissions from stationary installations and aviation activities, published on 14 November 2024 in Official Gazette No. 467-469, Article 868: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/2984/part/2#page=1 5. Order of the Minister of Environment No. 123 of 20 August 2025 on the approval of the List of operators of stationary installations whose activities are specified in Annex No. 1 to Law No. 74/2024 on climate actions: https://mediu.gov.md/sites/default/files/Ordin%20Instalatii.pdf 6. Order of the Minister of Environment No. 111 of 16 June 2026 on the approval of the Methodological Guideline for the development of GHG emissions monitoring plans for installations and aviation activities: https://mediu.gov.md/sites/default/files/Ordin%20nr.%20111%20din%2016.06.2026.pdf 7. Order of the Minister of Environment No. 113 of 18 June 2026 on the approval of the Methodological Guideline for the reporting of GHG emissions for installations and aviation activities: https://mediu.gov.md/sites/default/files/Ordin%20nr.%20113%20din%2018.06.2026%20_Ghid%20RAE.pdf
Double funding	The following third-party contributions were reported by Moldova in support of the implementation of this measure: i) technical assistance was provided under the EU4ClimateResilience project, for the development of Laws and regulations and ii) an expert was contracted under the project “Capacity Building for Climate Action

	in the Republic of Moldova", financed by the Green Climate Fund (GCF) and implemented by UNDP Moldova, for the development of the draft Methodological Guideline for the development of GHG emissions monitoring plans and reporting of GHG emissions for installations and aviation activities. These contributions consisted exclusively of technical assistance and expertise. While the third-party contributions were reported, the results were delivered by the Moldovan government.
Clear conclusion on the achievement of the step	**Satisfactorily fulfilled**

Pillar 6 – Energy security and efficiency

Reform: Guaranteeing security of supply

The step under review	Reform Agenda step No. 118: Moldova will progress on increasing its energy supply by the entry into force of the law aiming at transposing the EU Directive on oil stocks (Directive 2009/119/EC).
Description	Entry into force of the law aiming at transposing the Directive 2009/119/EC on imposing an obligation on Member States to maintain minimum stocks of crude oil and/or petroleum products. The specific law will provide for the creation and maintenance of petroleum stocks as an essential instrument for strengthening security of supply and improving the resilience of the domestic market, establishing the primary legal framework governing such stocks, including the rules on their establishment, maintenance, monitoring and use.
Baseline	No specific legislation in place.
Deadline of the step	30 June 2026
Commission assessment of results	Law No 119/2026 on the security of supply of petroleum products – aiming to transpose Directive 2009/119/EC imposing an obligation on Member States to maintain minimum stocks of crude oil and/or petroleum products was adopted and published in the Official Gazette on 30 June 2026. The law provides for the creation and maintenance of petroleum stocks as an essential instrument for strengthening security of supply and enhancing the resilience of the domestic market, establishing the primary legal framework

	governing such stocks, including the rules on their establishment, maintenance, monitoring, and use. This framework will improve the resilience of the domestic energy market.
Conclusion of the review of the step by the beneficiary	The beneficiary considers the step to be satisfactorily fulfilled.
Checks performed and evidence used in the verification of the step and related findings	1. Law No. 292/2026 on the security of supply of petroleum products, published on 30 June 2026 in the Official Gazette No. 288–290, Article 292: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3294/part/1#page=2
Double funding	Contributions from third parties in support of the achievement of this step were not reported.
Clear conclusion on the achievement of the step	**Satisfactorily fulfilled**

Pillar 6 – Energy security and efficiency

Reform: Thriving market for renewable energy

The step under review	Reform Agenda step No. 126: Launching of the Energy Storage support mechanism for the residential sector and for businesses.
Description	The mechanism supporting residential sector and businesses with acquiring battery storage systems is launched. For 2026 this is achieved by extending the scope of the existing financing programs for renewable energy and energy efficiency from the state budget.
Baseline	There is no support mechanism for consumers for purchasing battery storage systems.
Deadline of the step	30 June 2026
Commission assessment of results	The Energy Storage support mechanism has been launched for the residential and business sectors. For the residential sector, under the Residential Energy Efficiency Fund of Moldova (REEF) financing programme, implemented by the National Centre for Sustainable Energy (NCSE), the "Green House" financing product was approved by decision of the NCSE Governing Board on 17 June 2025. This product covers energy storage options and beneficiaries may receive grants covering up to 50% of the eligible investment costs, to a maximum of MDL 200 000 per beneficiary. The financing product includes eligible measures for the installation of electricity generation and energy storage systems. The budget allocation for this program increased from around MDL 240.5

	million in 2025 to MDL 252.5 million in 2026. A total of 188 applications for financing the installation of solar photovoltaic panel systems with energy storage batteries have been found eligible by end June 2026. The first disbursements have been made to six beneficiaries, making the financing mechanism operational and functional. For businesses, the "CREȘTEM IMM", the non-reimbursable financial support instrument for the development of small and medium-sized enterprises of the national Entrepreneurship Agency (ODA) was upgraded in September 2025 through the Government Decision No. 603/2025 integrating the previous instrument Retech Program on technological modernisation and energy efficiency. The budget allocation for technological modernisation and energy efficiency was increased from MDL 35 million in 2025 to MDL 65 million in 2026. As to implementation, under the technological modernisation and energy efficiency priority of the CRESTERE IMM instrument, 42 investment projects have been approved in 2025 and first half of 2026 with total grants amounting to MDL 17.1 million. In addition, MDL 100 million have been allocated for energy efficiency heading of the IMM Garant instrument under ODA's Credit Guarantee Fund for 2026, where no such heading existed in 2025.
Conclusion of the review of the step by the beneficiary	The beneficiary considers the step to be satisfactorily fulfilled.
Checks performed and evidence used in the verification of the step and related findings	1. Government Decision No. 251/2024 approving the Financing Programme "Residential Energy Efficiency Fund of the Republic of Moldova", published on 25 April 2024 in the Official Gazette No. 184–187, Article 361: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/2893/part/2#page=16 2. Government Decision No. 674/2025 amending certain Government Decisions (facilitating the implementation of energy efficiency projects), published on 24 October 2025 in the Official Gazette No. 540–543, Article 705: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3170/part/2#page=4 3. CNED Order No. 14/FEE of 3 July 2025 regarding the launch of the call for the collection of applications under the "Casa Verde" (Green House) Financing Product 4. Launch for grants under Casa Verde (Green House) for Call 1: investments in home energy efficiency, published on 11 March 2026 on CNED's website :

	https://cned.gov.md/ro/content/investitii-eficienta-energetica-locuintei-casa-verde-lanseaza-un-nou-apel-de-granturi-pentru 5. CNED Order No. 10/FEE of 16 March 2026 regarding the launch of Call No. 2 for the collection of participation applications under "Casa Verde" (Green House) financing product 6. Launch for grants under Casa Verde (Green House) for Call 2: for energy rehabilitation of individual homes, published on CNED's website on 17 March 2026: https://cned.gov.md/ro/content/casa-verde-guvernul-lanseaza-un-nou-apel-de-granturi-cu-un-buget-de-200-milioane-de-lei 7. "Green House" financing product: https://cned.gov.md/sites/default/files/document/attachments/20260311_produs_finantare_casa_verde_curat_1.pdf 8. Platform REEF: https://cned.gov.md/ro/feerm 9. Annual report 2025 on the energy efficiency fund program in the residential sector of the Republic of Moldova, published on CNED website: https://cned.gov.md/sites/default/files/document/attachments/20260604_raport_anual_feerm_2025_cned.pdf 10. Ministry of Finance Payment Order No. 215 on the disbursement of grants to beneficiaries, dated on the 12 June 2026 11. Government Decision No. 603/2025 approving the Regulation on the development, approval, implementation, and monitoring of support instruments for the establishment and development of small and medium-sized enterprises financed from the state budget, published on 19 September 2025 in the Official Gazette No. 494–497, Article 616: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3158/part/2#page=8 12. Presentation and Operational Manual for CREȘTERE IMM, non-reimbursable financial support instrument for the development of small and medium-sized enterprises dated 22 September 2025. 13. Extract from Minutes No. 9 of the meeting of the Council of the Agency for Entrepreneurship Development (ODA) on the approval of the financial support instrument for the development of SME's - "CREȘTERE IMM" ("SME Growth"), dated 22 September 2025 14. List of 42 investment project beneficiaries of CRESTERE IMM covering the period 2025 – Q1 2026

	15. Call for applications for the CREȘTEM IMM Instrument published on ODA website, press release dated 16 February 2026: https://www.oda.md/ro/media-page/presa/comunicate-de-presa/oda-relanseaza-apelurile-de-granturi-2026-300-de-milioane-de-lei-pentru-imm 16. Credit Guarantee Fund brochure published on ODA website: Produsul de garantare IMM GARANT.pdf 17. Overview table on budgetary allocations of financial instruments supporting energy storage objective for 2025 and 2026 prepared by ODA, July 2026
Double funding	Contributions from third parties in support of the achievement of this step were not reported.
Clear conclusion on the achievement of the step	**Satisfactorily fulfilled**

Pillar 6 – Energy security and efficiency
Reform: Guaranteeing security of supply

The step under review	Reform Agenda step No. 117: Moldova finalises the construction of 400 kV line Vulcanesti – Chisinau to secure its power system.
Description	New internal line 400 kV from Vulcanesti to Chisinau allows direct transmission of electricity imported from Romania to reach Moldovan capital and secure the system in a case of possible outages of 400 kV line Vulcanesti – MGRES (partially crossing the border with Ukraine) or 330 kV line MGRES – Chisinau.
Baseline	No power line.
Deadline of the step	31 December 2025 On 30 June 2026, the step was in the grace period until 31 December 2027.
Commission assessment of results	The construction of the single-circuit 400 kV overhead transmission line between Vulcanesti and Chisinau has been completed. The construction works were completed on 31 December 2025. As of 30 June 2026, the transmission line and all associated equipment have been completed and are ready for energisation and for acceptance testing. Until the testing is finalised, the direct transmission of electricity is not yet possible.
Conclusion of the review of the step by the beneficiary	The beneficiary does not consider the step to be satisfactorily fulfilled.
Checks performed and evidence used	1. Law No. 120/2022 on the declaration of public utility and national interest of the construction works for the Vulcanesti–

in the verification of the step and related findings	Chisinau 400 kV overhead transmission line and the Vulcanesti back-to-back station, published on 24 May 2022 in the Official Gazette No. 158 (8202), Article 278: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/2450/part/1#page=1Press release on the completion of the construction works at the Vulcanesti Substation, published on 11 June 2026 on the Ministry of Energy website https://energie.gov.md/ro/content/s-au-incheiat-lucrarile-de-constructie-la-statia-electrica-vulcanesti-statia-este-pregatita
Double funding	Assessment not yet applicable.
Clear conclusion on the achievement of the step	**Not satisfactory fulfilled**

Pillar 6 – Energy security and efficiency

Reform: Increasing energy security by reducing dependence on energy imports, diversifying energy suppliers and strengthening energy efficiency measures

The step under review	Reform Agenda step No. 113: Large industrial gas consumers procure gas on open gas market.
Description	Moldova government phases out the existing PSO for large industrial consumers. Moldova Gas market opened as of 1 October 2025 to all large industrial gas customers. There are 452 big customers, out of which 87 switched so far (19%), so there is room for further market opening.
Baseline	Existing legal framework: Gas law 2016/108.
Deadline of the step	31 December 2025 On 30 June 2026, the step was in the grace period until 31 December 2027.
Commission assessment of results	In July 2025, Moldova adopted Law No. 152/2025, which established the legal framework to introduce the gradual restriction for certain categories of consumers to access the supply of natural gas under the public service obligation regime. It provided that the National Agency for Energy Regulation (ANRE) would establish a timetable for the gradual restriction to large final consumers to access the supply of natural gas under the public service obligation. In accordance with the law, as of 1 April 2026, the public service obligation no longer applied in relation to large industrial consumers. Decision of ANRE No. 564 of 30 September 2025, established the timetable for the gradual restriction for large and medium non-

	household/industrial consumers to access the supply of natural gas under the public service obligation set out in Article 89(1) of Law No. 108/2016 on natural gas. According to this timetable, from 1 April 2026, large industrial consumers are no longer benefit from regulated tariff protection and are required to procure natural gas at prices negotiated on the competitive market. In accordance with the Decision of ANRE No. 425/2025 on the establishment of natural gas consumption thresholds for the identification and categorisation of industrial consumers, large industrial consumers are those consuming over 100,000 m³ of natural gas per year. By April 2026, most companies with a consumption exceeding 100,000 m³ of natural gas, namely 193 out of 203, had switched to the liberalised natural gas market. These 193 companies, representing 95% of the total, accounted for approximately 99% of the natural gas volume within the liberalised market. Around 5% of consumers have a seasonal consumption pattern and will subsequently return to contract natural gas on the free market. All large non-household consumers have completed the administrative formalities required for the transition.
Conclusion of the review of the step by the beneficiary	The beneficiary considers the step to be satisfactorily fulfilled.
Checks performed and evidence used in the verification of the step and related findings	1. Law No. 152/2025 amending certain legislative acts (security of natural gas supply and other aspects related to the natural gas sector), published on 4 July 2025 in the Official Gazette No. 346-349, Art. 437: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3116/part/1#page=1 2. ANRE Decision No. 564/2025 on the establishment of the timetable for the gradual restriction of access for large and medium industrial consumers to the supply of natural gas, within the context of the public service obligation, Article 89(1) of Law No. 108/2016 on natural gas: https://www.legis.md/cautare/getResults?doc_id=151054&lang=ro 3. ANRE Decision No. 519-522, art. 903, published in the Official Gazette on 3 October 2025: https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3164/part/3#page=10 4. ANRE Decision No. 425/2025 on the establishment of natural gas consumption thresholds for the identification and categorisation of industrial consumers, published on 21 July 2025 in the Official Gazette No. 385, art. 583:

	https://monitorul.gov.md/ro/monitorul/view/pdf/3128/part/3#page=1 5. List of large industrial consumers purchasing gas on liberalized market, last updated in April 2026: https://anre.md/schimbarea-furnizorului-3-319.
Double funding	Contributions from third parties in support of the fulfilment of this step were reported but the results were delivered by the Moldovan government.
Clear conclusion on the achievement of the step	**Satisfactorily fulfilled**

Pillar 7 – Fundamentals

Reform: Improve the effectiveness of the prevention and repression of corruption, including by improving the institutional and legislative framework

The step under review	Reform Agenda step No. 133: 95% of National Anticorruption Centre's (NAC) integrity assessment recommendations are integrated into the local integrity plans of evaluated institutions and at least 85% of recommendations are implemented.
Description	NAC is responsible for institutional integrity testing. It consists in evaluating institutions, identifying risks of corruption and formulating recommendations to address these risks and improve the integrity environment. NAC provides public annual reports on the implementation of its recommendations.
Baseline	In 2020-2024, 75% of integrity assessment recommendations are implemented by the evaluated institutions.
Deadline of the step	30 June 2026
Commission assessment of results	**Integration of NAC recommendations into the Integrity Plans** Between January 2025 and June 2026, the National Anticorruption Centre (NAC) provided recommendations on 19 Integrity Plans and monitored the inclusion of these recommendations in the final Integrity Plans. The five Integrity Plans approved by the Municipality of Chișinău integrated all 339 recommendations issued by NAC. Furthermore, the five Integrity Plans of the five district prefectures of the Municipality of Chișinău, the nine Integrity Plans of the Directorates-General subordinated to the Chișinău Municipal Council, and the Integrity Plan of the Chișinău City Hall all integrated all recommendations issued by NAC. For the national public institutions, the integration of NAC recommendations was at around 99-100%, out of the 463 recommendations issued. The Integrity Plans of the Civil Aviation

	Authority (86 recommendations), of the Competition Council (117 recommendations), and of the State Labour Inspectorate (77 recommendations) integrated all NAC recommendations. The State Tax Service integrated 99% of the 182 recommendations issued by NAC. **Implementation of NAC recommendations on the Integrity Plans:** Between January 2025 and June 2026, NAC assessed the implementation of its recommendations to the Integrity Plans in 16 public institutions The rate of implementation ranged from 86% to 98%, with an average of 91% of full implemented actions, as follows: 1. Chișinău City Hall – fully implemented recommendations: 78 out of 91 (86%) 2. Ciocana District Administration – fully implemented recommendations: 83 out of 89 (93%). 3. Buiucani District Administration – fully implemented recommendations: 87 out of 89 (98%). 4. Rîșcani District Administration – fully implemented recommendations: 81 out of 89 (91%). 5. General Directorate for Economy, Trade and Tourism – fully implemented recommendations: 89 out of 95 (94%). 6. Botanica District Administration – fully implemented recommendations: 81 out of 89 (91%). 7. Centru District Administration – fully implemented recommendations: 84 out of 89 (94%). 8. General Directorate for the Protection of Children's Rights – fully implemented recommendations: 87 out of 95 (92%). 9. General Directorate for Education, Youth and Sports – fully implemented recommendations: 85 out of 95 (89%). 10. General Directorate for Urban Mobility – fully implemented recommendations: 85 out of 95 (89%). 11. General Directorate for Finance – fully implemented recommendations: 88 out of 95 (93%). 12. General Directorate for Medical and Social Assistance – fully implemented recommendations: 93 out of 95 (98%). 13. General Directorate for Housing and Communal Services – fully implemented recommendations: 83 out of 95 (87%). 14. General Directorate for Culture and Cultural Heritage – fully implemented recommendations: 79 out of 84 (94%). 15. General Directorate for Architecture, Urbanism and Land Relations – fully implemented recommendations: 90 out of 103 (87%).

	16. National Road Transport Agency (ANTA) – fully implemented recommendations: 68 out of 79 (86%).
Conclusion of the review of the step by the beneficiary	The beneficiary considers the step to be satisfactorily fulfilled.
Checks performed and evidence used in the verification of the step and related findings	1. Decision of the NAC Board No. 4 on NAC recommendations being integrated into the Integrity Plans and on implementation of recommendations, published on 17 July 2026 on NAC website: https://cna.md/sites/default/files/media/documents/2026-07/Hotararea%20Colegiului%20nr.%204%20din%2017.07.2026.pdf 2. Table provided by NAC presenting an overview of 19 Integrity Plans integrating NAC's recommendations, July 2026 3. Table provided by NAC presenting implemented recommendations, July 2026.
Double funding	Contributions from third parties in support of the achievement of this step were not reported.
Clear conclusion on the achievement of the step	**Satisfactorily fulfilled**

Pillar 7 – Fundamentals

Reform: Improve the effectiveness of the prevention and repression of corruption, including by improving the institutional and legislative framework

The step under review	Reform Agenda step No. 132: 100% of National Anticorruption Centre's (NAC) recommendations on corruption risks mitigating measures are addressed in the final draft laws. If some of the recommendations are not accepted, a written justification should be made.
Description	NAC ensures the ex-ante evaluation of risks of corruption for draft legislations. It evaluates the risks of corruption in draft laws and presents an assessment report to the relevant public authority which developed the draft law. The report is then made public. The relevant authority is legally obliged to consider this assessment and integrate NAC's comments. When the institutions cannot follow the NAC recommendations due to legislative constraints, they must provide written justification.
Baseline	In 2020-2024: 76% of NAC recommendations are reflected in the final draft laws.
Deadline of the step	30 June 2026

Commission assessment of results	In accordance with the legal framework in place (Law No 100/2017 and No. 1104/2002), the National Anticorruption Centre (NAC) ensures the ex-ante evaluation of risks of corruption for draft legislations. In 2025, NAC monitored 46 Government meetings during which 1 072 draft normative acts were approved, out of which 694 were subject to the mandatory anticorruption expertise. For these 694 draft acts, NAC issued 699 recommendations on risk factors linked to corruption and included them in the anticorruption expertise reports. All recommendations were addressed by the authorities. Out of the 699 recommendations, 590 were accepted and integrated into the final versions of draft normative acts (84,5%), and 109 were not accepted (15,5%). All of them were examined and included a written justification. From January to June 2026, 27 Government meetings were monitored, during which 521 draft normative acts were approved, out of which 297 were subject to the mandatory anticorruption expertise. NAC issued 263 recommendations on risk factors linked to corruption and included them in the anticorruption expertise reports. All recommendations were addressed by the authorities. Out of 263 recommendations, 224 were accepted and incorporated into the final versions of the draft normative acts (85%), and 39 were not accepted (15%). All of them were examined and included a written justification.
Conclusion of the review of the step by the beneficiary	The beneficiary considers the step to be satisfactorily fulfilled.
Checks performed and evidence used in the verification of the step and related findings	1. Database of government meetings containing information on draft normative acts and supporting materials, in accordance with Articles 36 and 39 of Law No. 100/2017 on Normative Acts: https://gov.md/ro/sedinte-de-guvern 2. Database of anticorruption expertise reports on draft normative acts published on the website of the National Anticorruption Centre: https://cna.md/ro/rapoarte-de-expertiza 3. Monitoring table of Government meetings held in 2025, containing information used to verify how the recommendations issued by the National Anticorruption Centre in the anticorruption expertise reports were addressed and implemented.

	4. Monitoring table of Government meetings held in 2026, up to 30 June 2026, containing information on how the recommendations issued by NAC were addressed.
Double funding	Contributions from third parties in support of the fulfilment of this step were not reported.
Clear conclusion on the achievement of the step	**Satisfactorily fulfilled**

Pillar 7 – Fundamentals

Reform: Strengthening independence, accountability, and integrity of the justice system

The step under review	Reform Agenda step No. 135: All members of the Superior Council of Magistracy (SCM) specialised boards are appointed and all of them have been previously vetted.
Description	The SCM specialised boards are responsible for disciplinary procedures and selection and evaluation procedures for judges. They are composed in total of 7 members and 9 members, respectively.
Baseline	As of April 2025, SCM Disciplinary Procedures Board had 5 vetted members (out of 7 members in total). SCM Selection and Evaluation Board had 6 vetted members (out of 9 members in total).
Deadline of the step	30 June 2026
Commission assessment of results	The Superior Council of Magistracy **(SCM) Evaluation Board** has reached full composition with nine vetted members. Three members have been appointed during the reporting period: - One candidate passed pre-vetting in July 2023 and was appointed in January 2026 - One candidate passed the vetting in June 2024 and was appointed in January 2026 - One candidate passed the vetting in March 2024 and was appointed in March 2026. The **SCM Disciplinary Board** has not reached full composition and is still missing two members out of seven. Multiple competitions were organised in 2026 to appoint the two last candidates. In February, four applications were submitted, and in April, one candidate was admitted to the interview and successfully passed it. His file was sent to the Vetting Commission for evaluation but subsequently on 18 June, the candidate withdrew from the competition. One additional application was received in April 2026, and the candidate successfully passed the competition in May 2026. In June 2026, his file was sent to the Vetting Commission for

	evaluation. The Ministry of Justice launched another competition with a deadline of 10 July 2026, later extended to 12 August due to the lack of candidates applying.
Conclusion of the review of the step by the beneficiary	The beneficiary considers the step to be partially fulfilled.
Checks performed and evidence used in the verification of the step and related findings	1. SCM Plenary Decision No. 139/9 of 31 March 2026: https://www.csm.md/files/Hotaririle/2026/09/139-9.pdf 2. SCM Plenary Decision No. 2/1 of 20 January 2026: https://www.csm.md/files/Hotaririle/2026/01/2-1.pdf 3. Positive evaluations by the Vetting Commission for three candidates issued on 20 June 2024, 31 July 2023 and 28 March 2024. 4. Announcement on the launch of the competition, under which four applications were received: https://www.justice.gov.md/ro/content/anunt-privind-organizarea-concursului-pentru-selectarea-candidatilor-la-functia-de-membru 5. Announcement of the Selection Commission for candidates for membership of the SCM Disciplinary Procedures Board, for which the interview will take place on 2 April 2026: https://www.justice.gov.md/ro/content/anuntul-comisiei-de-selectie-candidatilor-la-functia-de-membru-colegiul-disciplinar-al 6. Announcement of the results of the interview stage for the position of member of the SCM Disciplinary Procedures Board, following the interview that took place on 2 April 2026: https://www.justice.gov.md/ro/content/anunt-privind-rezultatele-etapei-interviului-pentru-functia-de-membru-colegiul-disciplinar 7. The Vetting Commission initiated the integrity assessment procedure in respect to one of the candidates on 24 April 2026: https://www.vettingmd.eu/ro/comunicate-de-presa/avocatul-andrei-rezus-a-depus-documentele-initiale-pentru-evaluarea-integritatii 8. Announcement extending the competition until 28 April 2026: https://www.justice.gov.md/ro/content/anunt-privind-organizarea-concursului-pentru-selectarea-candidatilor-la-functia-de-membru-0

	9. Announcement on the admission of one candidate to the interview stage that took place on 12 June 2026: https://www.justice.gov.md/ro/content/comisia-de-selectie-candidatilor-la-functia-de-membru-colegiul-disciplinar-al-judecatorilor 10. Announcement of the results of the interview stage, which was successfully passed by one candidate following the interview that took place on 12 June 2026: https://www.justice.gov.md/ro/content/anunt-privind-rezultatele-etapei-interviului-pentru-functia-de-membru-colegiul-disciplinar-0 11. Announcement that the Evaluation Commission initiated the assessment procedure in respect of one candidate, published on 22 June 2026: https://www.vettingmd.eu/ro/comunicate-de-presa/un-nou-candidat-la-colegiul-disciplinar-al-csm-intra-in-evaluare 12. Announcement of withdrawal of a previously selected candidate, published on 23 June 2026: https://www.vettingmd.eu/ro/comunicate-de-presa/un-avocat-s-a-retras-din-concursul-pentru-colegiul-disciplinar-al-judecatorilor 13. Launch of a new competition: https://www.justice.gov.md/ro/content/anunt-privind-organizarea-concursului-pentru-selectarea-candidatilor-la-functia-de-membru-1
Double funding	Assessment not yet applicable.
Clear conclusion on the achievement of the step	**Not satisfactory fulfilled**